



PAPEL

Research Archiving System
PUP Biñan Campus

HANDBOOK FOR USERS AND THE SYSTEM TEAM

Workflow Handbook

How research papers are uploaded, approved, published and archived. Step by step, in simple English, with pictures.

14

workflows

3

diagrams for each:
use case, sequence, ERD

7

kinds of users

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Each workflow has the same parts: **In short**, **the steps**, **Remember**, and three diagrams. You can read only the parts you need.

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About This Handbook

This handbook explains how PAPEL works, step by step.

PAPEL is the research archiving system of PUP Biñan Campus. Students upload their research papers. Teachers check them. Approved papers are shared with the public. Later, old papers can be archived.

Who should read it

Students, Research Advisers, the Research Coordinator, the Head of Academic Programs, the Director, Librarians and guests. Also the people who look after the system: they will find notes for them in Appendix D.

How each workflow is arranged

- 1 **In short:** one sentence about the workflow.
- 2 **Who takes part:** the people, and any outside service.
- 3 **The steps:** what to do, in order.
- 4 **Remember:** the important rules.
- 5 **Words to know:** new words, explained simply.
- 6 **Three diagrams:** a use case diagram (who does what), a sequence diagram (what happens behind the screen) and an ERD (where the information is saved).

Good to know

You do not need the diagrams to use PAPEL. The steps are enough. The diagrams are for people who want to see how PAPEL works inside. Start Here 3 explains how to read them.

How words are written

- Words in **bold** are the words you see on the screen, like **Submit Paper**.
- Words in **this style** are names used inside the system, like the status **draft**. You do not need them to use PAPEL.
- "Workflow 5" means chapter 5 of this handbook.

The parts of the book

Part	What it covers
Start Here	This introduction, the people, how to read the diagrams, and the big picture.
A · Accounts and Signing In	Workflows 1 and 2.
B · Submitting a Paper	Workflows 3, 4 and 5: uploading, drafts and cancelling.
C · Review and Approval	Workflows 6, 7 and 8: the two reviews, and fixing a returned paper.
D · The Public Repository	Workflows 9, 10 and 11: reading papers, guest passes, full manuscripts.
E · Records and Help	Workflows 12, 13 and 14: archiving, notices, and account help.
Appendices	The database map, common questions, words to know, notes for the system team.

START HERE · 2

The People in PAPEL

Seven kinds of people use PAPEL. Each one has a home page and a job.

Who	What they do	Their home page
Student	Writes a paper and uploads it. Fixes it if it is returned.	My Dashboard
Research Adviser	Checks the papers of their own students first. Makes student accounts.	Review Desk
Research Coordinator	Gives the final approval. Approving a paper publishes it. Makes Research Adviser and Librarian accounts.	Review Desk
Head of Academic Programs	Reads all published papers and the reports. Does not approve.	My Dashboard
Director	Reads all published papers. Archives papers. Makes staff accounts. Chooses the Google Drive folder.	My Dashboard
Librarian	Makes guest passes. Answers requests to open a full manuscript.	Guest Passes
Guest	A visitor with a pass that works for a few hours. Can read paper details.	Public Repository

Good to know

Your Research Adviser is the faculty member who made your account. Your papers always go to that person first.

Approval ends at the Research Coordinator

Only two people approve a paper: the Research Adviser, then the Research Coordinator. The Head of Academic Programs and the Director **read** the published papers. They do not approve them.

Outside services

PAPEL uses four services from other companies. In the diagrams they are blue boxes marked «system».

Service	What PAPEL uses it for
Google Drive	Keeps the PDF files of submitted papers.
Gmail	Sends emails: sign-in details, notices and reminders.

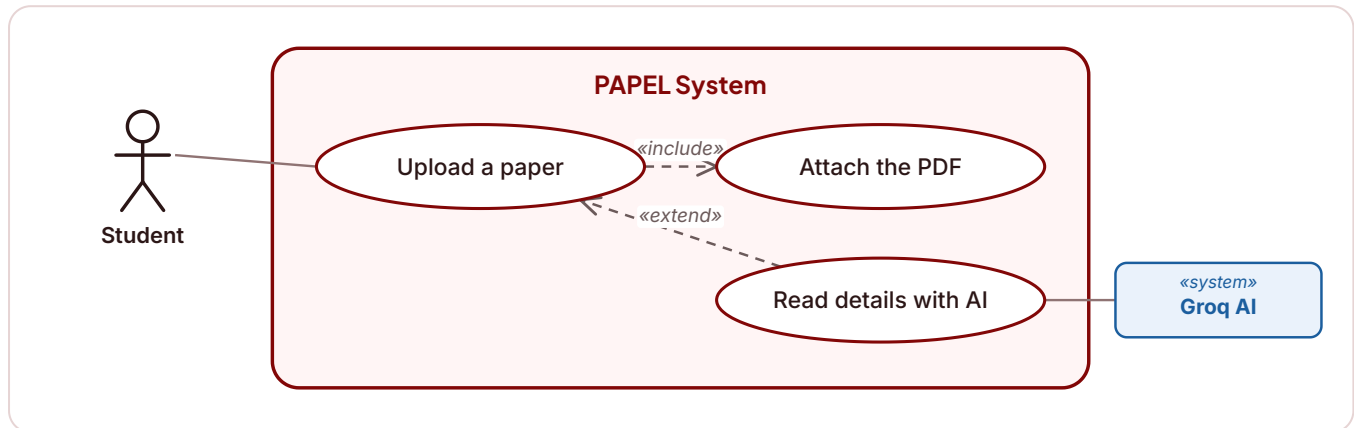
Service	What PAPEL uses it for
Groq AI	Reads a PDF and fills in the title, authors and abstract. Writes the AI summary. Runs the PUPPY helper.
Google reCAPTCHA	The "I'm not a robot" check on the sign-in panel, when it is turned on.

START HERE · 3

How to Read the Diagrams

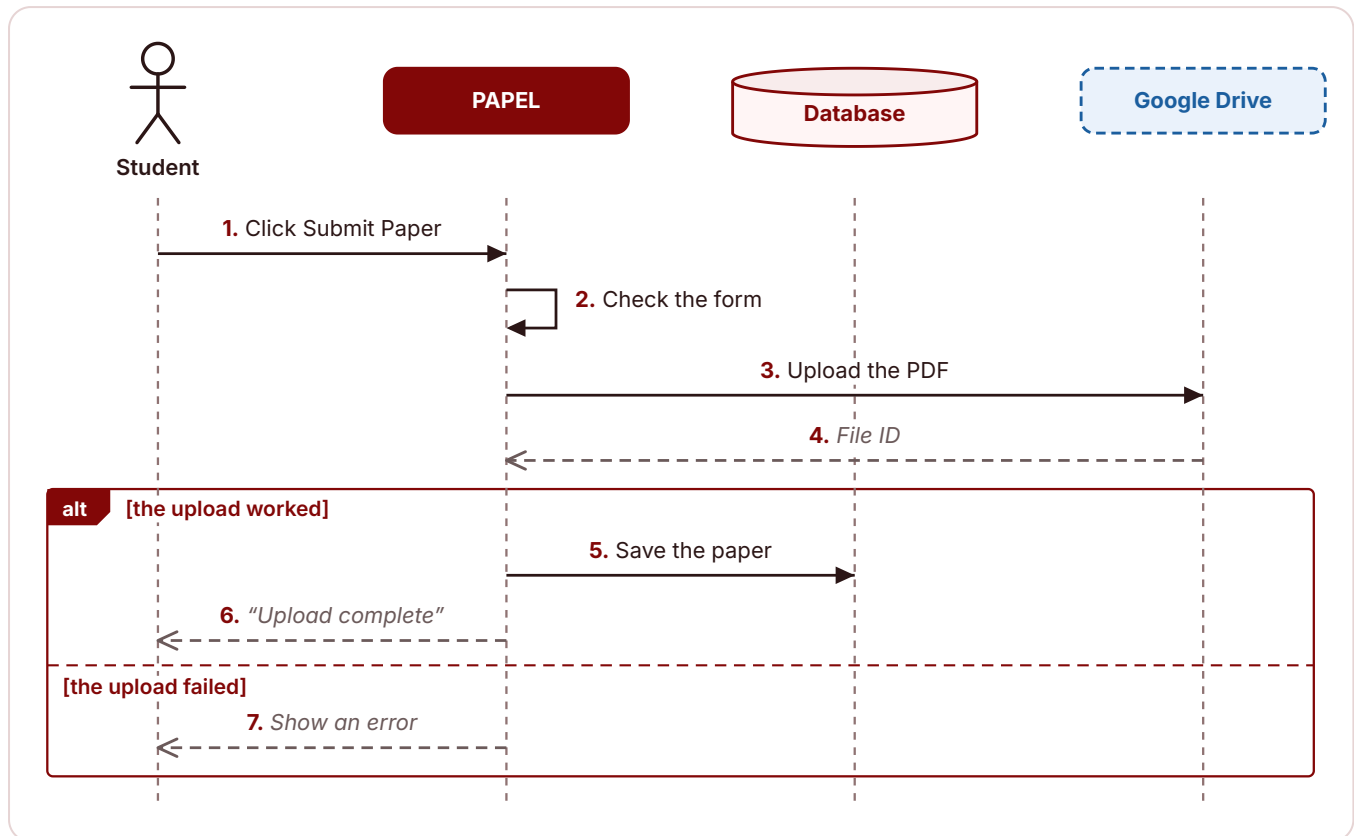
Each workflow has three diagrams. They follow UML, a standard way of drawing software. Here is how to read them.

1. The use case diagram: who does what



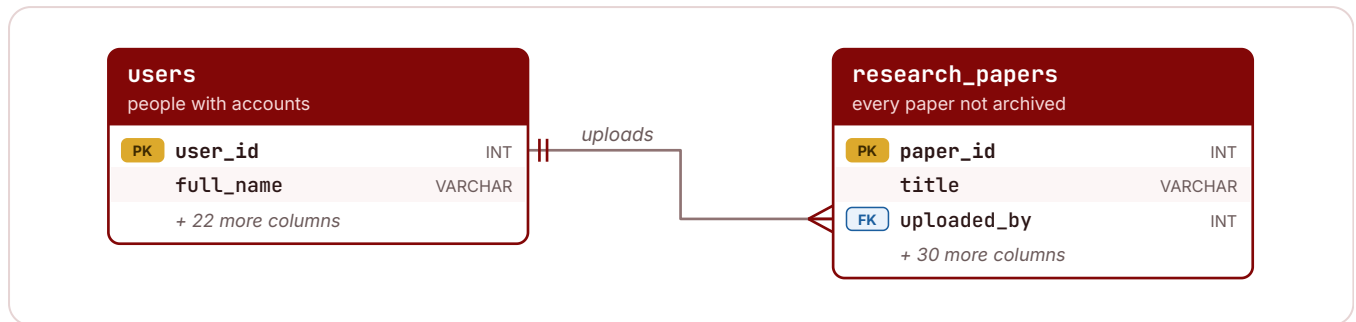
- A **stick figure** is a person. It is called an *actor*.
- A **blue box** marked «system» is an outside service, like Google Drive.
- The **big pink box** is PAPEL. Everything inside it happens in PAPEL.
- An **oval** is one thing a person can do. It is called a *use case*.
- A **plain line** means: this person does this.
- A dashed arrow marked «include» means: this step *always* happens as part of the other.
- A dashed arrow marked «extend» means: this step happens *only sometimes*.

2. The sequence diagram: what happens, in order



- The boxes at the top are the **people and the parts** of the system. The maroon box is PAPEL. The cylinder is the database. Blue dashed boxes are outside services.
- The **dashed line** going down from each box is its *lifeline*. Time goes down.
- A **solid arrow** is a request or an action. The **number** shows the order.
- A **dashed arrow** is an answer coming back.
- A **loop arrow** means the part does something by itself.
- An **alt** box has two or more paths. Only one happens. The words in [brackets] say when.
- An **opt** box happens only sometimes. A **loop** box repeats.
- A **yellow note** explains something.

3. The ERD: where the information is saved



- ERD means *Entity Relationship Diagram*. Each **box** is one table in the database. The dark top shows the table's name.
- Each line in the box is one **column**: one piece of information.
- **PK** (primary key) is the ID that makes each row different.
- **FK** (foreign key) is an ID that points to a row in another table.
- Two short bars **||** at the end of a line mean **one**. The three-toed **crow's foot** means **many**. The example reads: one user uploads many papers.
- Each workflow shows only the columns it uses. "+ 20 more columns" tells you the rest are hidden. Appendix A has the full map.

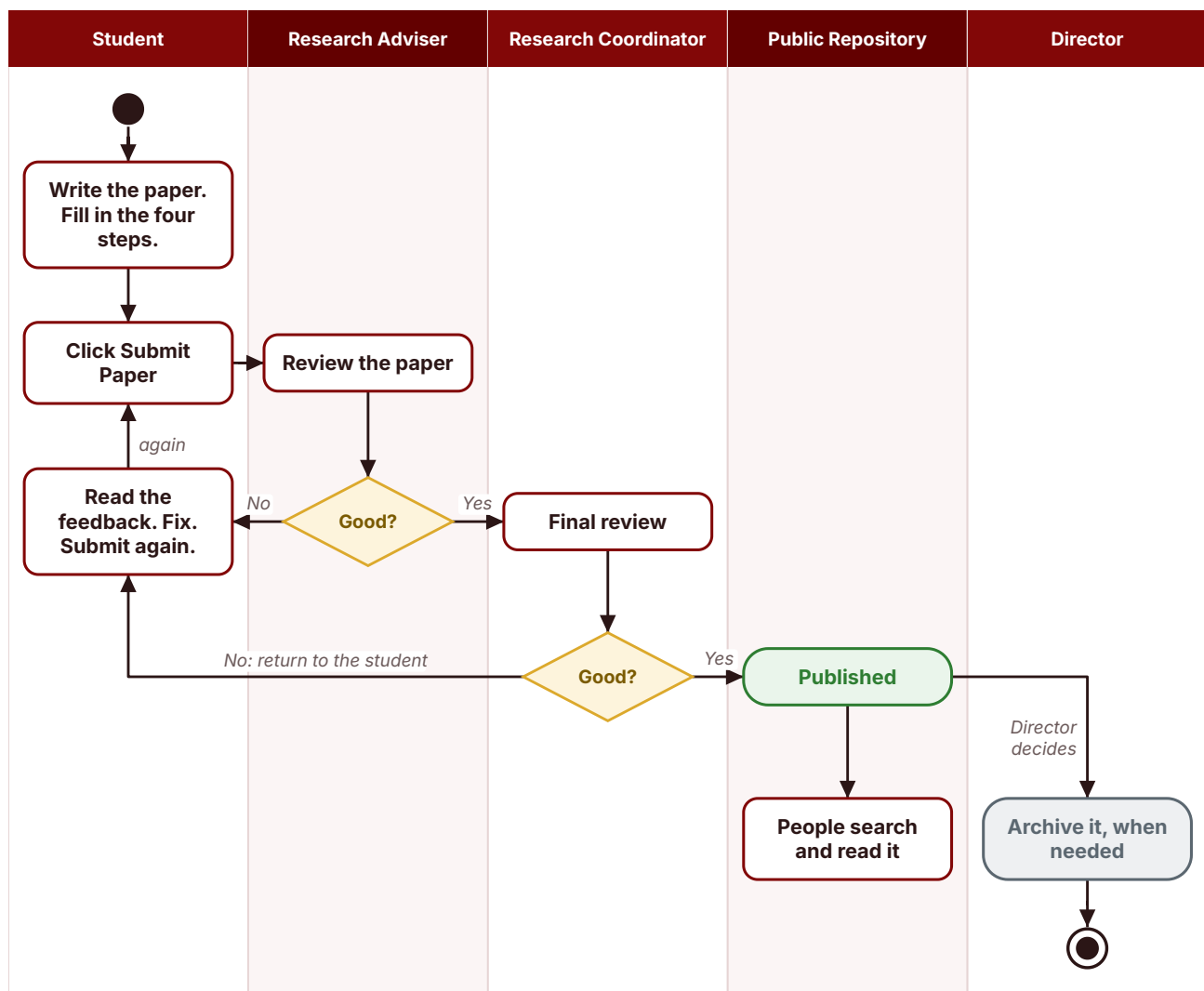
START HERE · 4

The Big Picture

A paper moves through PAPEL in five stages.

- 1 The **student** writes the paper and uploads it.
- 2 The **Research Adviser** checks it.
- 3 The **Research Coordinator** checks it again and approves it.
- 4 The paper is **published** in the Public Repository. Everyone can find it.
- 5 Later, the **Director** can move it to the archive.

At stage 2 or stage 3, the reviewer can **return** the paper. The student fixes it and sends it again. It then starts again at the Research Adviser.

Figure 0.1 ACTIVITY DIAGRAM**The journey of a paper**

What it shows: Each column is one person or place. Follow the arrows from the black dot at the top. A diamond is a question. "Yes" moves the paper on. "No" sends it back to the student.

The status of a paper

The **status** says where a paper is in the process. Your dashboard shows it as a badge on the paper's card.

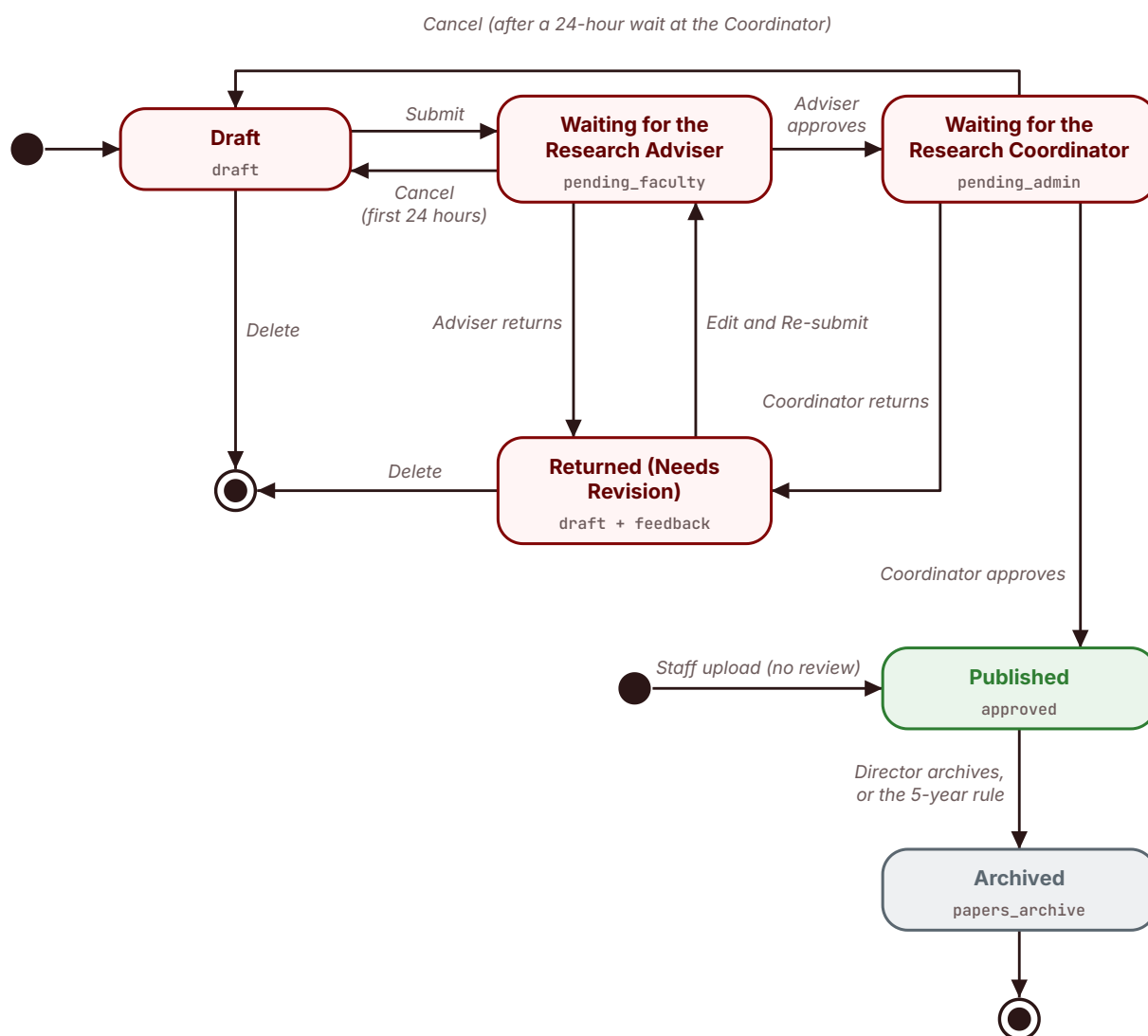
The badge you see	What it means	Status inside the system
DRAFT	Not sent yet. Only you can see it.	draft
ON PROCESS	Waiting for the Research Adviser.	pending_faculty
ON PROCESS	The Adviser approved it. Waiting for the Research Coordinator.	pending_admin
DECLINED	A reviewer returned it. Read the feedback and fix it.	draft plus feedback

The badge you see	What it means	Status inside the system
APPROVED	Published. Everyone can find it in the Public Repository.	approved
(not shown)	Archived. Taken out of the Public Repository.	moved to papers_archive

Your dashboard also has four tabs: **Approved**, **Under Review**, **Needs Revision** and **Drafts**.

Figure 0.2 STATE MACHINE DIAGRAM

Every status, and how a paper moves between them



What it shows: Each rounded box is a status. Each arrow is something that changes the status. The small grey text is the name the system uses. A staff member's own paper skips the review and is published at once.

WORKFLOW 01 · PART A · ACCOUNTS AND SIGNING IN

Signing In

IN SHORT You sign in with your ID and your password.

Who takes part

Students

All staff

Guests

Outside services

Google reCAPTCHA

The **Sign In** button is at the top of every page. It opens a sign-in panel. The panel has three tabs.

Tab	Who uses it	What to type as your ID
Student	Students	Your Student ID
Faculty	Research Advisers, the Research Coordinator, the Head of Academic Programs, the Director and Librarians	Your Employee ID, or your email
Guest	Visitors with a guest pass	The guest username from your email

Steps

- 1 Click **Sign In** at the top of the page.
- 2 Choose your tab: **Student**, **Faculty** or **Guest**.
- 3 Type your ID.
- 4 Type your password.
- 5 Tick **I'm not a robot**, if you see it.
- 6 Click the sign-in button.
- 7 PAPEL opens your home page. (See the table of people in Start Here 2.)

Remember

- **Five wrong passwords lock the account for 15 minutes.** This stops people who try to guess passwords. Wait 15 minutes, then try again.
- Twenty wrong tries from one computer lock that computer for 15 minutes, for every account.
- Choose the right tab. A staff account cannot sign in on the **Student** tab.
- A student account has an end date. After that date it stops working. Ask your Research Adviser to renew it.
- Forgot your password? Use **Contact Support**. See Workflow 14.

How long a student account lasts

The end date comes from your year level and section. PAPEL counts school years from the academic year on your account. The account ends on **31 July** of the last school year.

Your section	Your account lasts
1st year (1-1, 1-2, ...)	5 school years
2nd year (2-1, 2-2, ...)	4 school years
3rd year (3-1, 3-2, ...)	3 school years
4th year (4-1, 4-2, ...)	2 school years
Ladderized	2 school years

To renew an account, the Research Adviser moves the student up a year. PAPEL then works out a new end date.

Words to know

ID —The number the school gave you, like a Student ID or Employee ID.

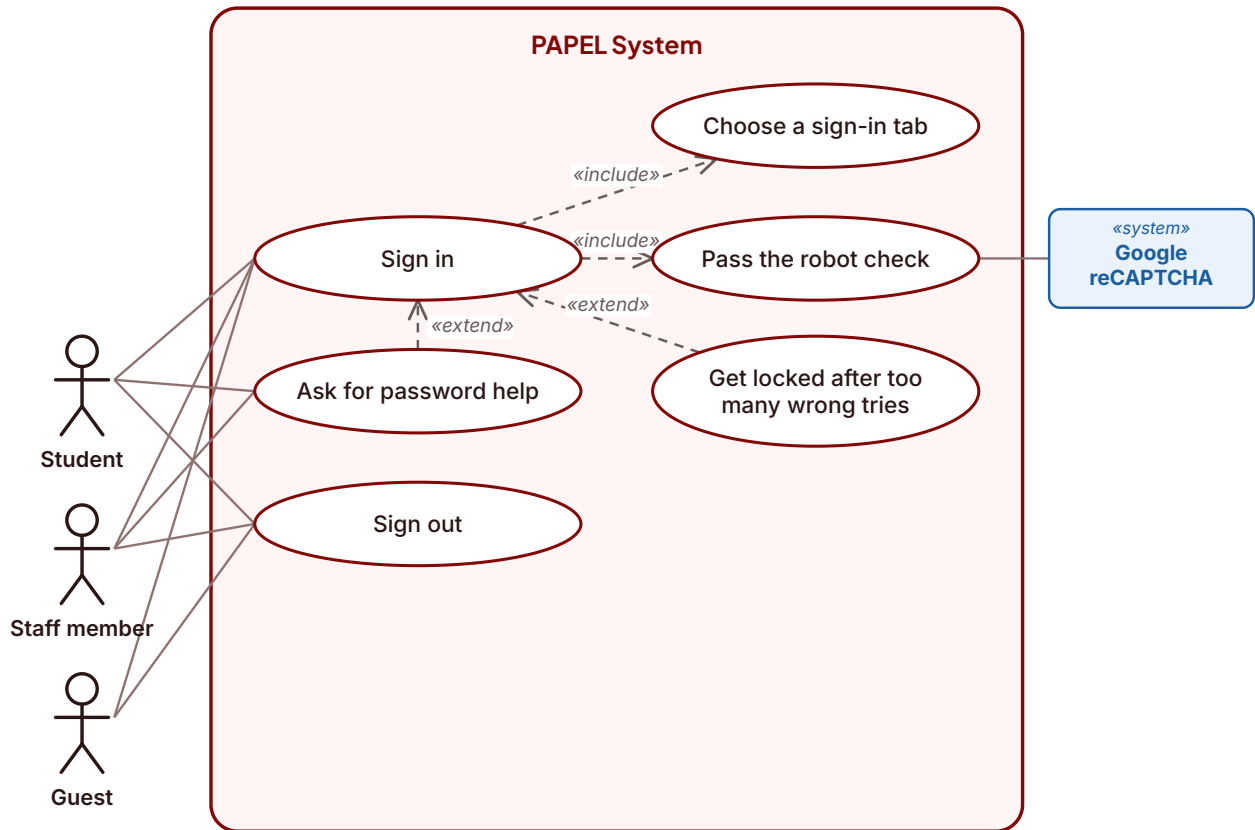
Lock —PAPEL stops accepting tries for a short time.

Expire —To reach the end date and stop working.

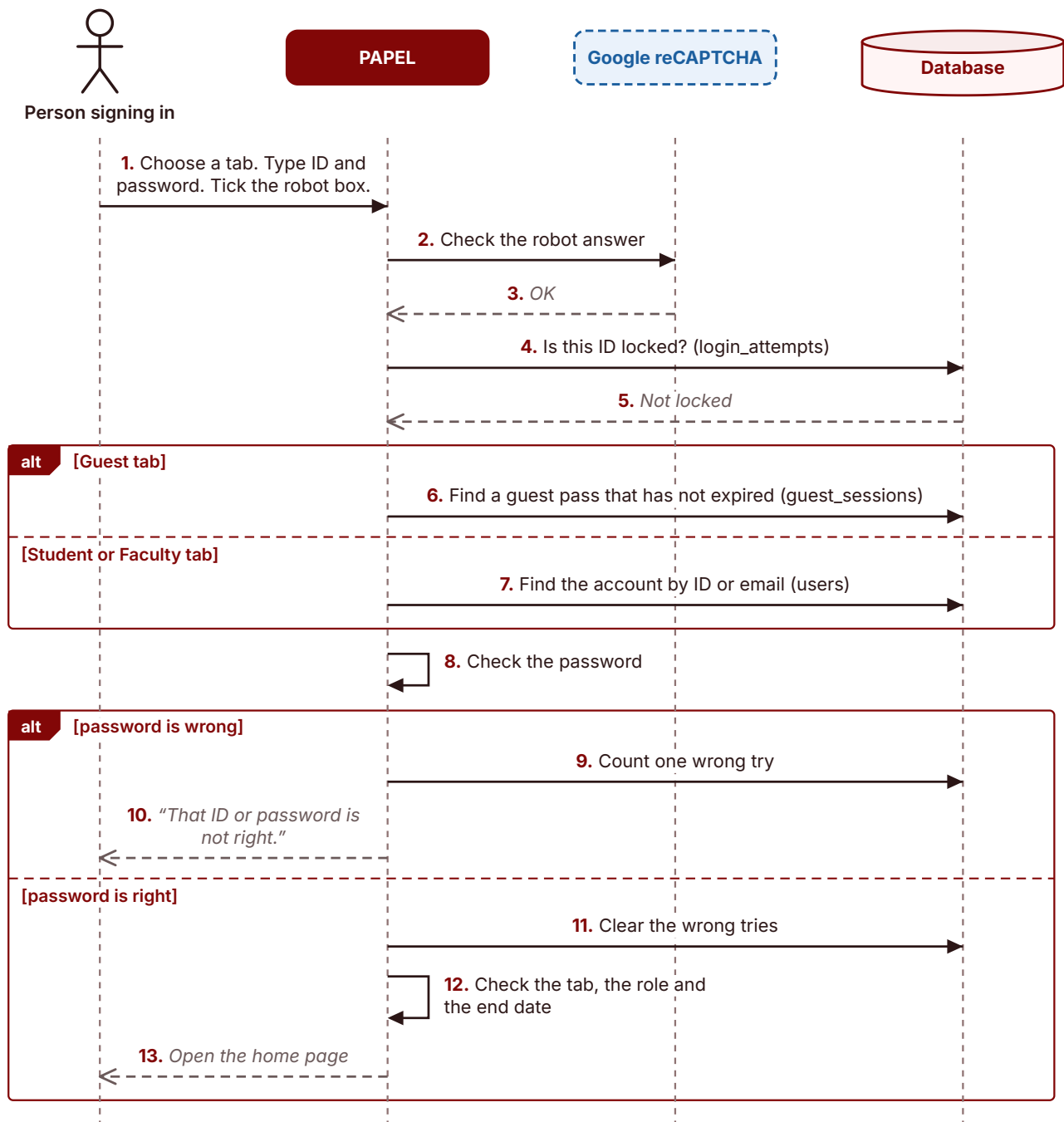
The diagrams for Workflow 1

Figure 1.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

Who does what



What it shows: Everyone signs in the same way. Choosing a tab and passing the robot check are always part of signing in. Being locked out and asking for help happen only sometimes.

Figure 1.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The robot check comes first, before the password is looked at. This stops robots from testing passwords. The lock check comes next.

Figure 1.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

users people with accounts		
PK	user_id	INT
	student_id	VARCHAR
	faculty_id	VARCHAR
	email	VARCHAR
	password	VARCHAR
	user_role	ENUM
	admin_level	TINYINT
	is_active	TINYINT
	expires_on	DATE
+ 15 more columns		

guest_sessions guest passes		
PK	guest_id	INT
	username	VARCHAR
	password	VARCHAR
	expires_at	DATETIME
+ 2 more columns		

login_attempts wrong sign-in tries		
PK	scope	VARCHAR
	attempts	INT
	first_at	DATETIME
	last_at	DATETIME
	locked_until	DATETIME

These three tables are not joined by IDs. PAPEL reads them one after another: first login_attempts (is this ID locked?), then guest_sessions for the Guest tab, or users for the Student and Faculty tabs. password is stored scrambled (hashed), never as plain text.

What it shows: Sign-in reads three tables. "users" holds real accounts. "guest_sessions" holds guest passes. "login_attempts" counts wrong tries.

WORKFLOW 02 · PART A · ACCOUNTS AND SIGNING IN

Creating User Accounts

IN SHORT Accounts are made from the top down. Each person makes the accounts of the people below them.

Who takes part

Director

Research Coordinator

Research Adviser

Outside services

Gmail

Nobody can make their own account. Someone above you makes it.

Who makes it	Which accounts	Page
Director	Research Coordinator, Head of Academic Programs, Librarian	Manage Admins
Research Coordinator	Research Advisers and Librarians	Manage Faculty (the page is called Advisers & Librarians)
Research Adviser	Students	My Students

Good to know

The person who makes a student account becomes that student's Research Adviser. The student's papers always go to that person first.

Steps: a Research Adviser makes a student account

- 1 Open **My Students**.
- 2 Fill in the form: full name, Student ID, email, program, section and academic year.
- 3 Click **Generate** to make a password. It is made from the name and the ID, for example **JuanDeLaCruz-056**.
- 4 Save the account.
- 5 PAPEL checks that the Student ID and the email are not used yet.
- 6 PAPEL works out the end date of the account from the section (see Workflow 1).
- 7 PAPEL emails the student their Student ID and password.
- 8 The password shows on your screen **one time only**. Write it down if the email fails.

Staff accounts are made in the same way, on **Manage Admins** or **Manage Faculty**. PAPEL emails the sign-in details to the new staff member.

Remember

- A password needs **at least 6 characters, one capital letter and one number**.
- Tell new users to change their password after they sign in for the first time.
- To renew a student, edit the account and move the student up a year.
- PAPEL records every password change: whose password, who changed it, and when.

Words to know

Account —Your name, ID and password in PAPEL.

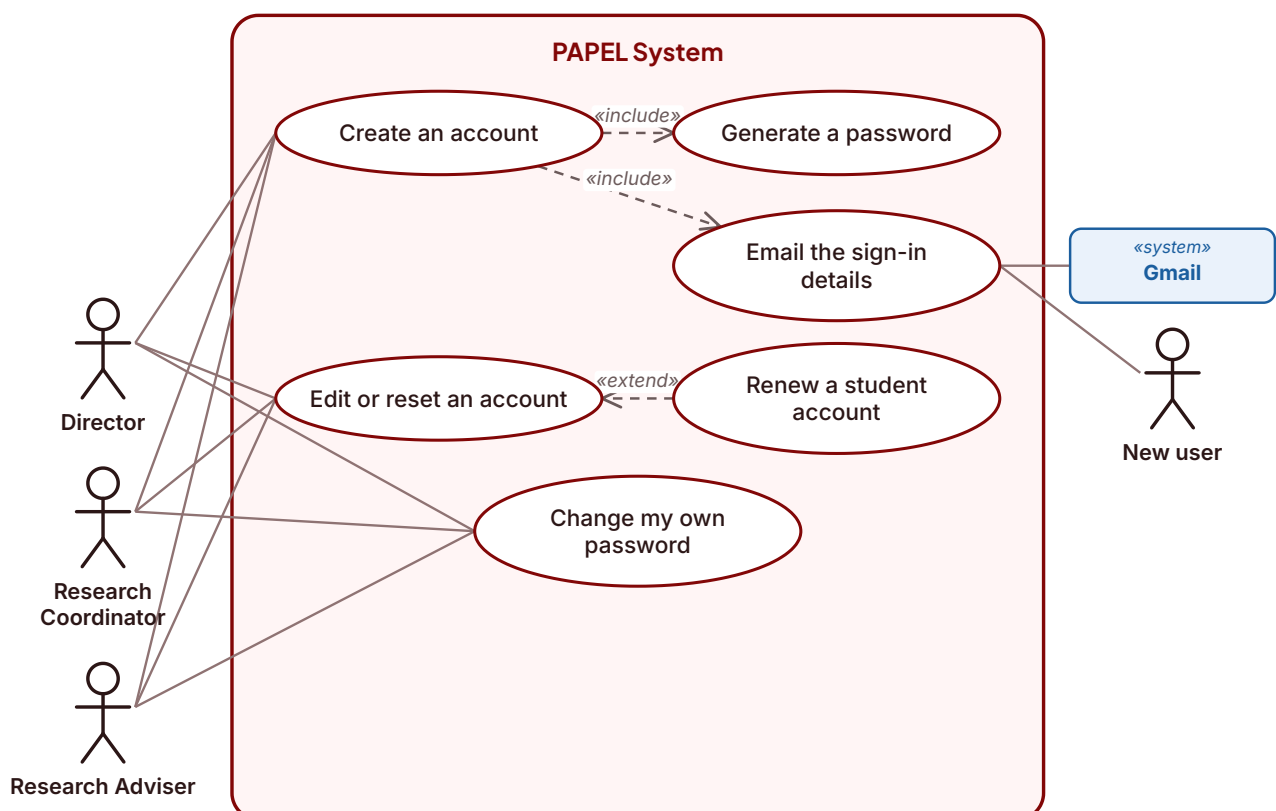
Generate —Let PAPEL make something for you, here a password.

Renew —Give an account a new end date.

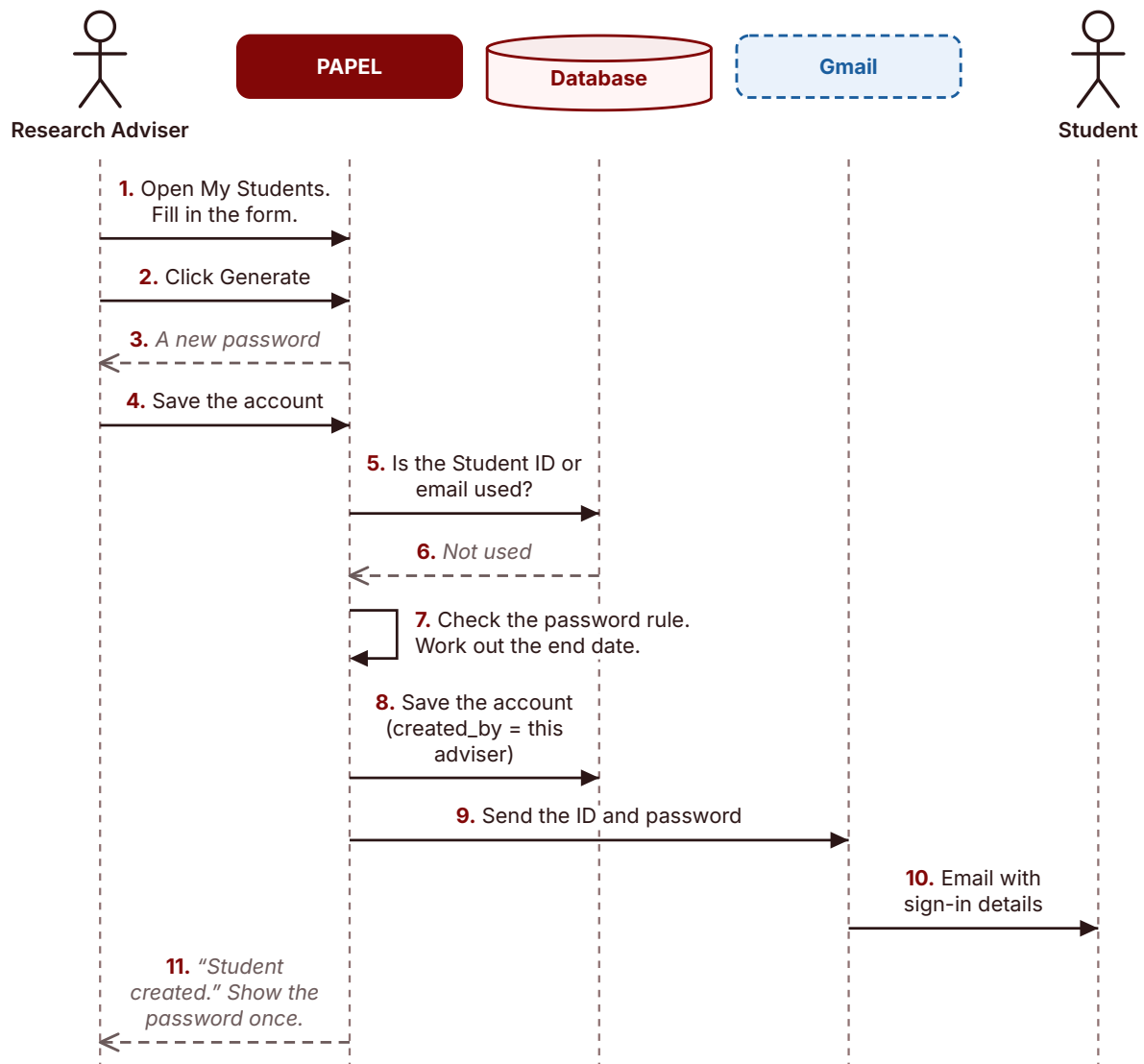
The diagrams for Workflow 2

Figure 2.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

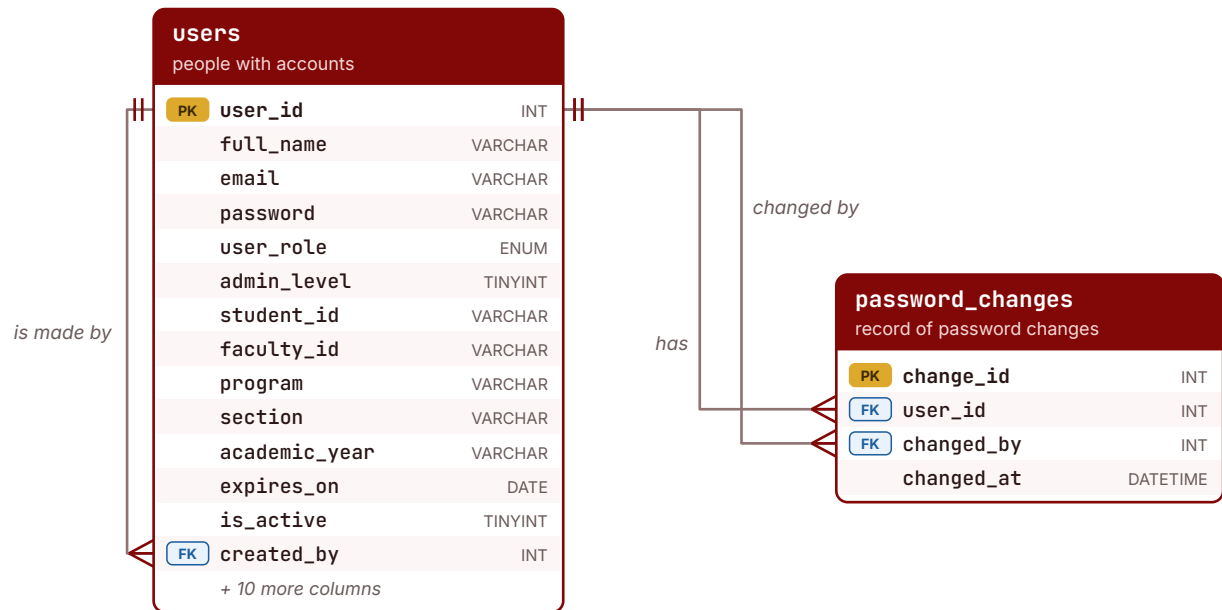
Who does what



What it shows: Three people can create accounts, each for the people below them. Every new account gets a password and an email. Renewing a student is a special kind of edit.

Figure 2.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The Adviser's own user ID is saved in the new account (created_by). That link is what sends the student's papers to this Adviser later.

Figure 2.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: An account points to the account that made it (created_by). The line that goes out of "users" and back into it shows this. Each password change is one row in "password_changes".

WORKFLOW 03 · PART B · SUBMITTING A PAPER

Uploading a Paper

IN SHORT The student fills in four steps and submits the paper. It goes to their Research Adviser.

Who takes part

Student

Research Adviser (gets a notice)

Outside services

Groq AI

Google Drive

Gmail

Open **Upload Paper** from your dashboard. The upload page has four steps. You can go back to an earlier step at any time.

Step 1: Paper Details

- Choose your academic program, the paper type and the other basic facts.
- Paper types: **Capstone Project**, **Undergraduate Thesis**, **Conference Paper**, **Journal Article** and **Feasibility Study**.

Step 2: Upload & Details

- Attach your paper as a **PDF** file. The page accepts files up to 50 MB.
- Choose how to fill in the details:
- **Extract Metadata with AI**: PAPEL reads your PDF. It fills in the title, authors, year, keywords and abstract. If the AI is busy, wait a minute and press it again, or fill the details in yourself.
- **Fill Manually**: you type the details yourself.
- **Always check what the AI wrote**. Fix any mistakes.
- Write or paste each section of your paper: Abstract, Introduction, Methodology, Results and Discussion, Conclusion, References.
- You can paste pictures into a section. Each picture can be up to 5 MB.

Step 3: Supporting Docs

A **Capstone Project** needs all four documents below. For the other paper types, they are optional. Every document must be a PDF.

- Ethics Clearance
- Consent Form
- Data Collection Tool
- Copyright / IP Document

Step 4: Review & Submit

Check everything one last time. Then click **Submit Paper**.

What happens after you click **Submit Paper**

- 1 PAPEL checks that every required part is there.
- 2 PAPEL sends your PDF and your documents to Google Drive. Submitted papers are kept there.
- 3 PAPEL saves the paper. The badge on your card says **ON PROCESS**.
- 4 Your Research Adviser gets a notice and an email.
- 5 You go back to your dashboard. The paper is in the **Under Review** tab.

Remember

- Your paper always goes first to **your** Research Adviser: the faculty member who made your account.
- If the upload to Google Drive fails, the paper is **not** submitted. Try again later.
- You can save your work before you submit. See Workflow 4.
- You can cancel a submission for a short time. See Workflow 5.
- Staff can upload their own papers too. A staff paper is **published at once**, with no review.

Words to know

PDF —A file type for documents. It looks the same on every computer.

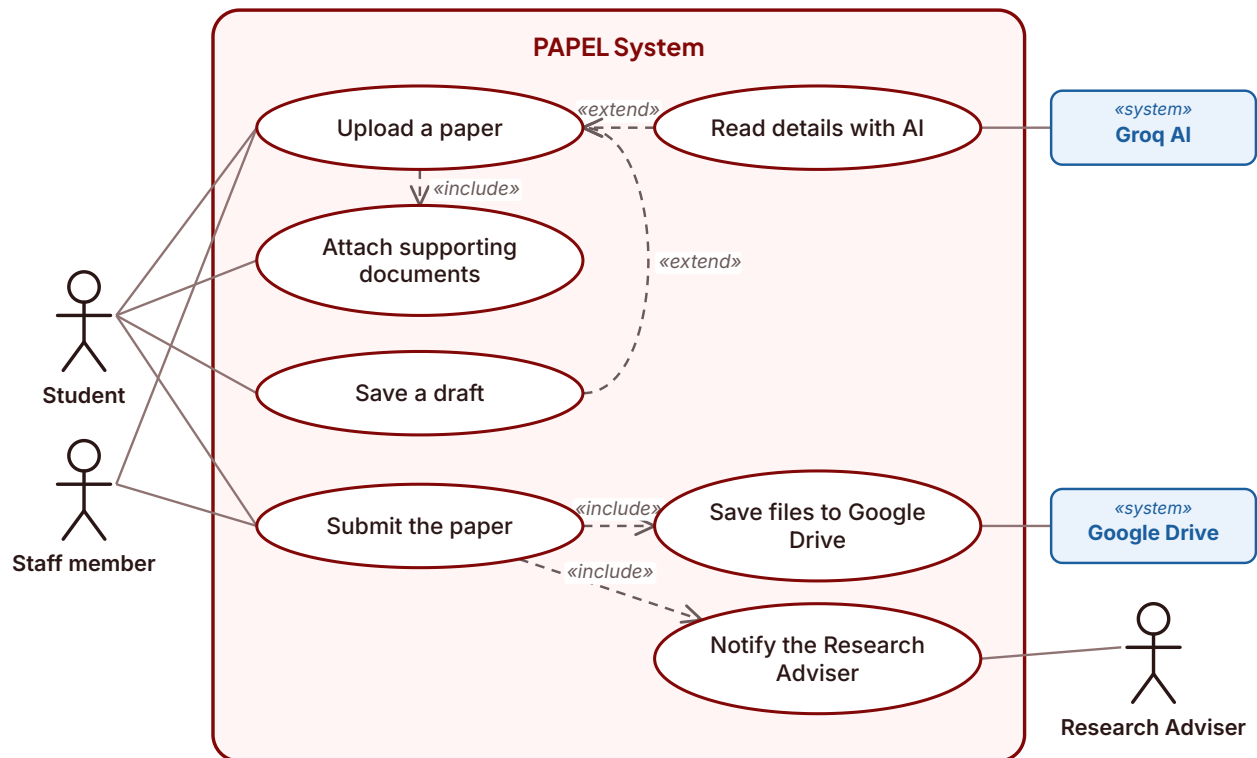
Metadata —Basic facts about a paper, like the title, authors and year.

Submit —Send your paper for review.

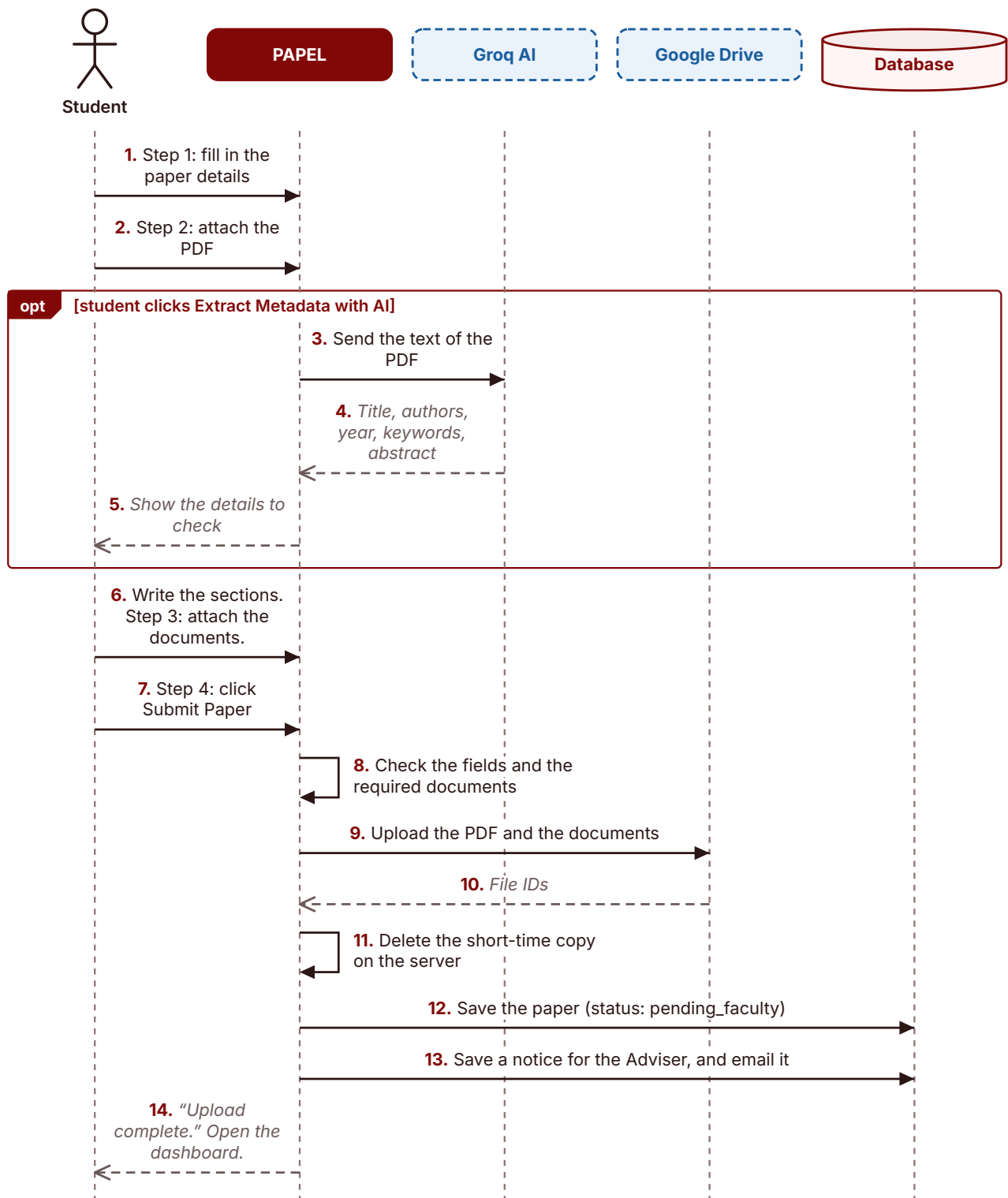
The diagrams for Workflow 3

Figure 3.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

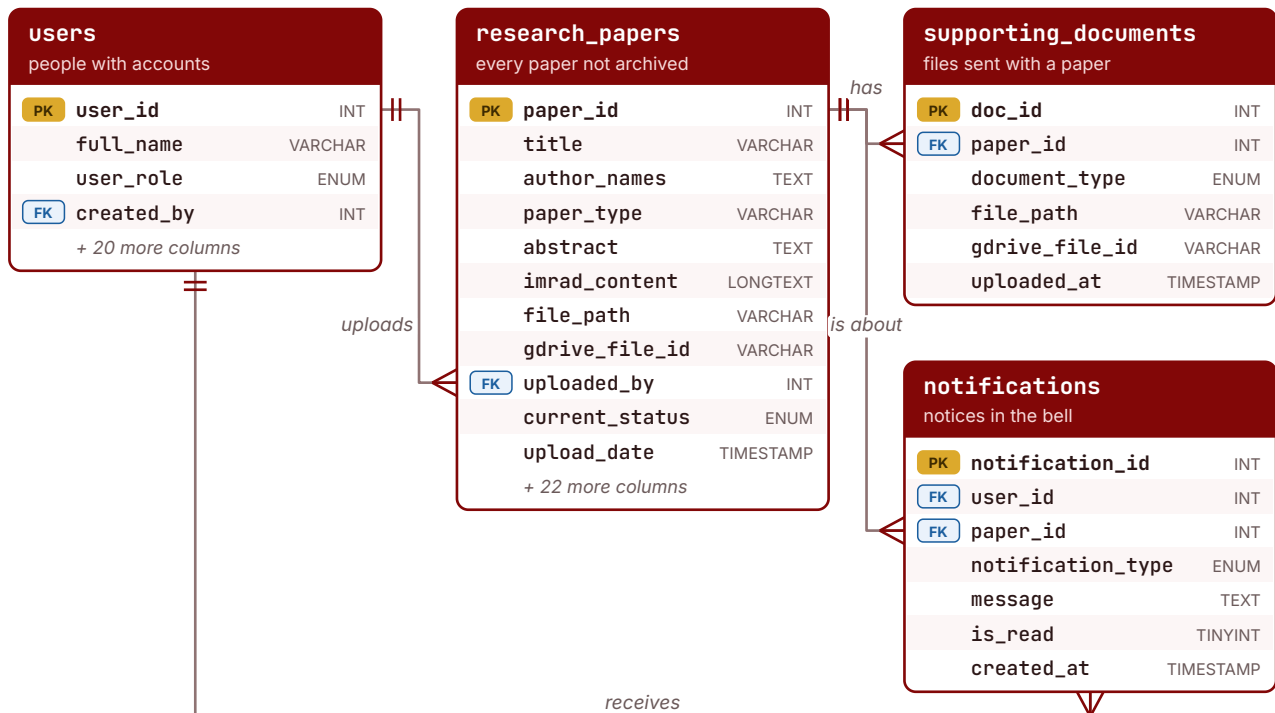
Who does what



What it shows: The student uploads and submits the paper. Using the AI and saving a draft are optional. Every submission saves its files to Google Drive and tells the Research Adviser.

Figure 3.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The PDF stays on the PAPEL server only for a moment. After Google Drive has it, the server copy is deleted. If the Drive upload fails, nothing is saved.

Figure 3.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: One user uploads many papers. One paper has many supporting documents. A notice belongs to one user and is about one paper. The sections of the paper are kept in `imrad_content`. `gdrive_file_id` is the file's address in Google Drive.

WORKFLOW 04 · PART B · SUBMITTING A PAPER

Saving a Draft

IN SHORT A draft keeps your unfinished paper, so you can continue later.

Who takes part

Student

PAPEL keeps your work in two different ways. It is important to know the difference.

	Automatic copy	Save as Draft button
Where is it kept?	In your browser, on this device only	On the PAPEL server
When is it saved?	By itself, a moment after you stop typing	When you click Save as Draft
What is kept?	Your typed text and your choices	Your typed text, your choices and your PDF
Is the PDF kept?	No. You must attach it again.	Yes
Is it on your dashboard?	No	Yes, in the Drafts tab
Can you open it on another computer?	No	Yes

Steps: save a draft

- 1 Fill in what you have so far.
- 2 Click **Save as Draft** at the bottom of the upload page.
- 3 A message says **Draft saved**.
- 4 Later, find it in the **Drafts** tab on your dashboard.

Steps: continue a draft

- 1 Open your dashboard.
- 2 Open the **Drafts** tab.
- 3 Click **Continue editing** on the draft.
- 4 Finish the steps. Then click **Submit Paper**.

Steps: delete a draft

- 1 Click the delete (trash) button on the draft card.

2 Confirm. The draft and its PDF are removed.

Remember

- Supporting documents are **not** saved in a draft. Attach them when you submit.
- Drafts are **not** sent to Google Drive. They stay on the PAPEL server.
- If you save again with a new PDF, the old PDF is deleted.
- Nobody reviews a draft. Only you can see it. To send it for review, you must submit it.
- If you come back to the upload page on the same device, PAPEL asks **Continue your draft?**
- Pictures you paste into a section are saved on the server at once.

Words to know

Draft —Work that is not finished and not sent.

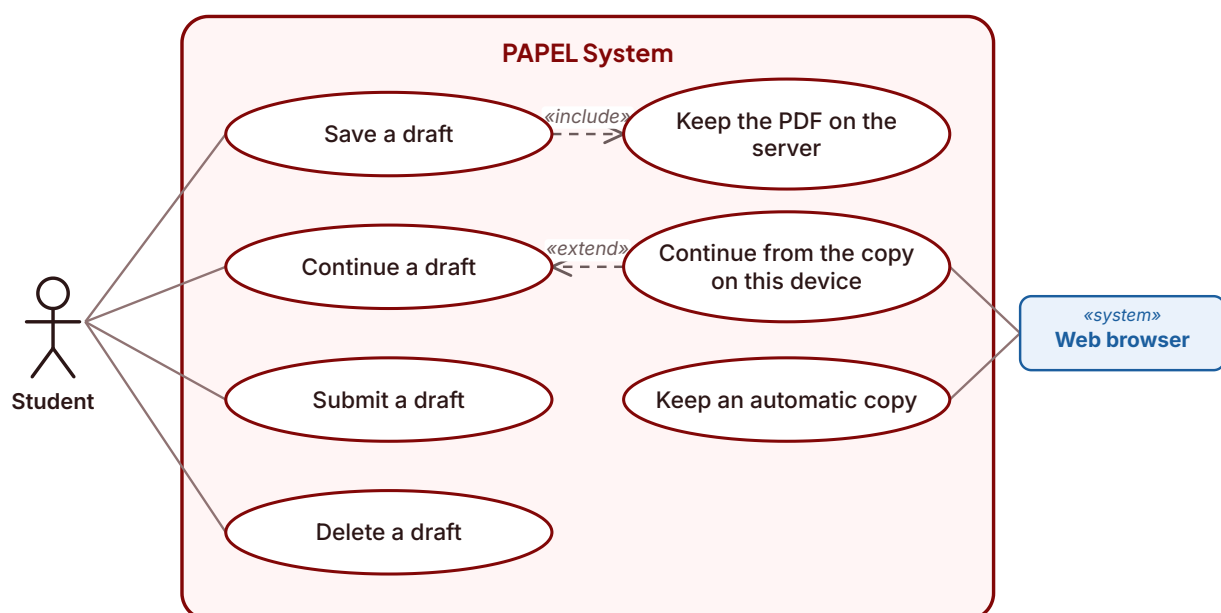
Browser —The program you use to open websites, like Chrome or Edge.

Device —Your computer, tablet or phone.

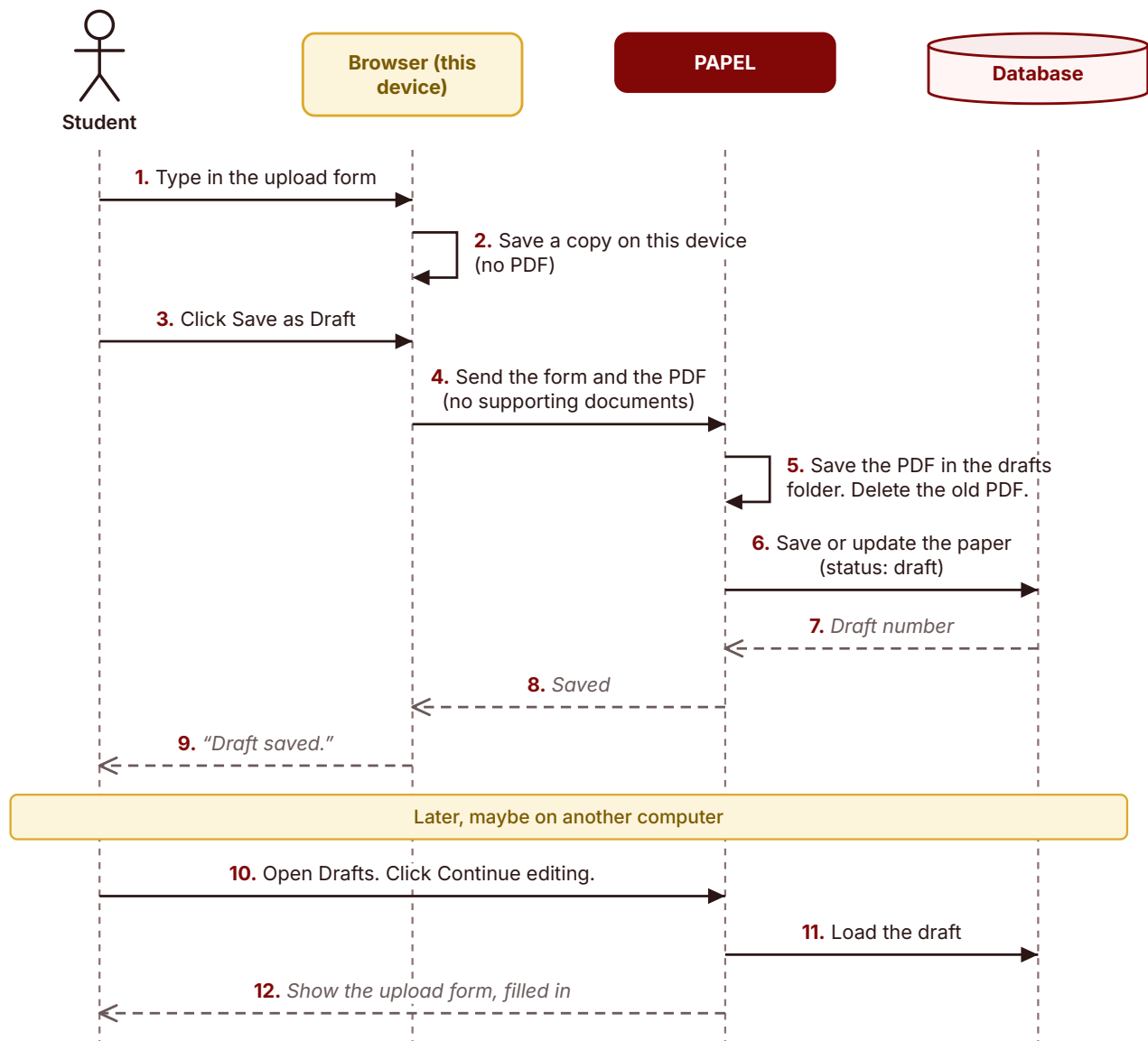
The diagrams for Workflow 4

Figure 4.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

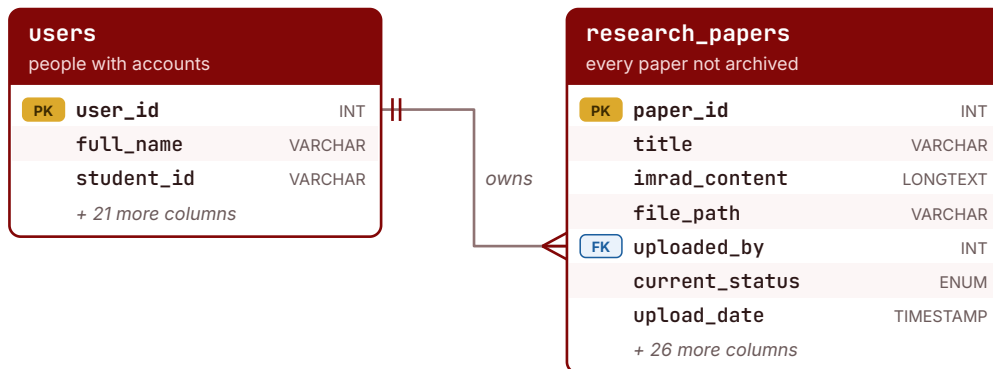
Who does what



What it shows: The student saves, continues, submits or deletes a draft. The web browser keeps its own copy by itself. That copy can fill the form again on the same device.

Figure 4.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The browser copy never leaves your device. Only the Save as Draft button sends your work, and your PDF, to PAPEL.

Figure 4.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

A saved draft is a row with `current_status = 'draft'`. `file_path` points to its PDF on the server, in `app/student/uploads/drafts/<user_id>/.`

The automatic copy is kept by the browser (localStorage). It is not in the database, and it never holds the PDF.

Pictures pasted into a section are files in `uploads/section_images/<user_id>/.` The section text in `imrad_content` points to them.

What it shows: A draft is an ordinary paper row with the status "draft". Its PDF is a file on the server, not in Google Drive.

WORKFLOW 05 · PART B · SUBMITTING A PAPER

Cancelling a Submission

IN SHORT You can take back a submitted paper, but only at certain times.

Who takes part

Student

Research Adviser and Research Coordinator (get a notice)

After you submit, your paper card shows a **Cancel submission** button when it is allowed. Cancelling brings the paper back to you as a draft.

Where is your paper?	When can you cancel?
With your Research Adviser	Only in the first 24 hours after you submit.
With the Research Coordinator	Only after the Coordinator has had it for 24 hours with no decision.
Published	You cannot cancel.

Why is it different? At the first stage, 24 hours give you time to change your mind. After that, the Adviser should not review a paper that keeps changing. At the second stage, your paper already has an approval. So you can take it back only if it waits too long.

Steps

- 1 Open your dashboard. Go to the **Under Review** tab.
- 2 Find the paper.
- 3 Click **Cancel submission**.
- 4 A box asks **Withdraw this submission?** Click **Withdraw it**.
- 5 The paper goes back to your **Drafts**.
- 6 Your reviewers get a notice.

Remember

- Approvals that were already given stay on record.
- If the time has passed, the card tells you why. Ask your Research Adviser for help.
- If a reviewer acts at the same moment as you, the reviewer's decision wins.
- To send the paper again, open the draft and submit it. It starts again with your Research Adviser.

Words to know

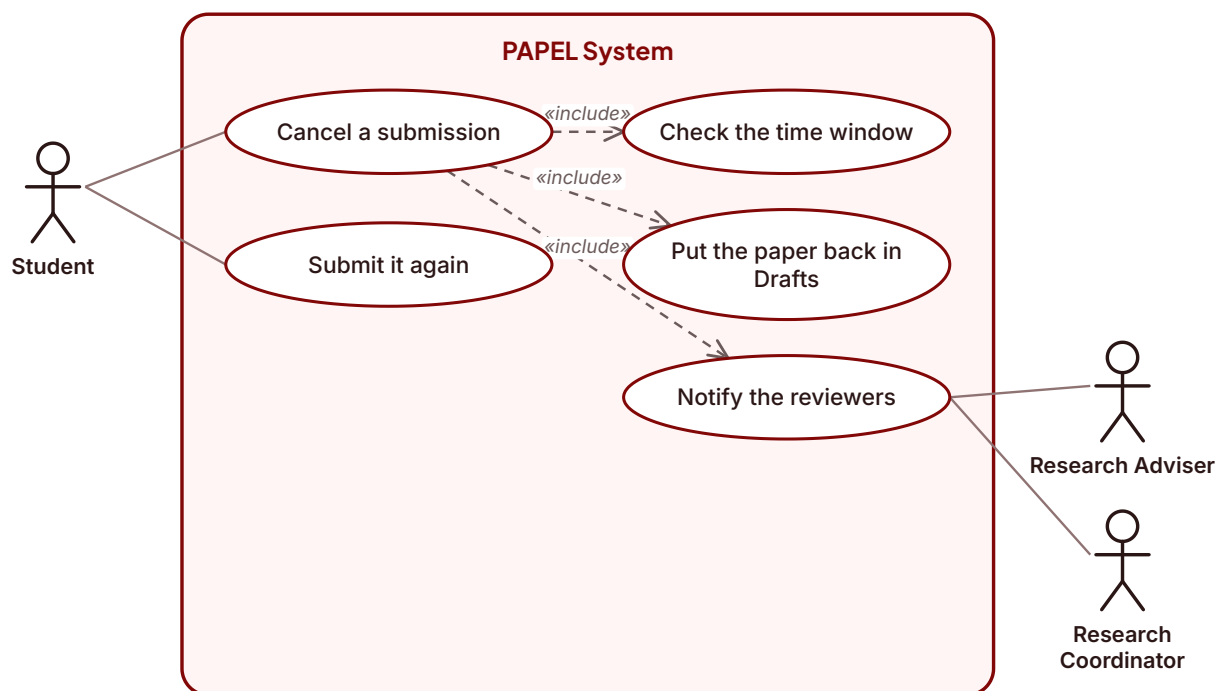
Cancel / Withdraw —Take back something you sent.

Window —The time when something is allowed.

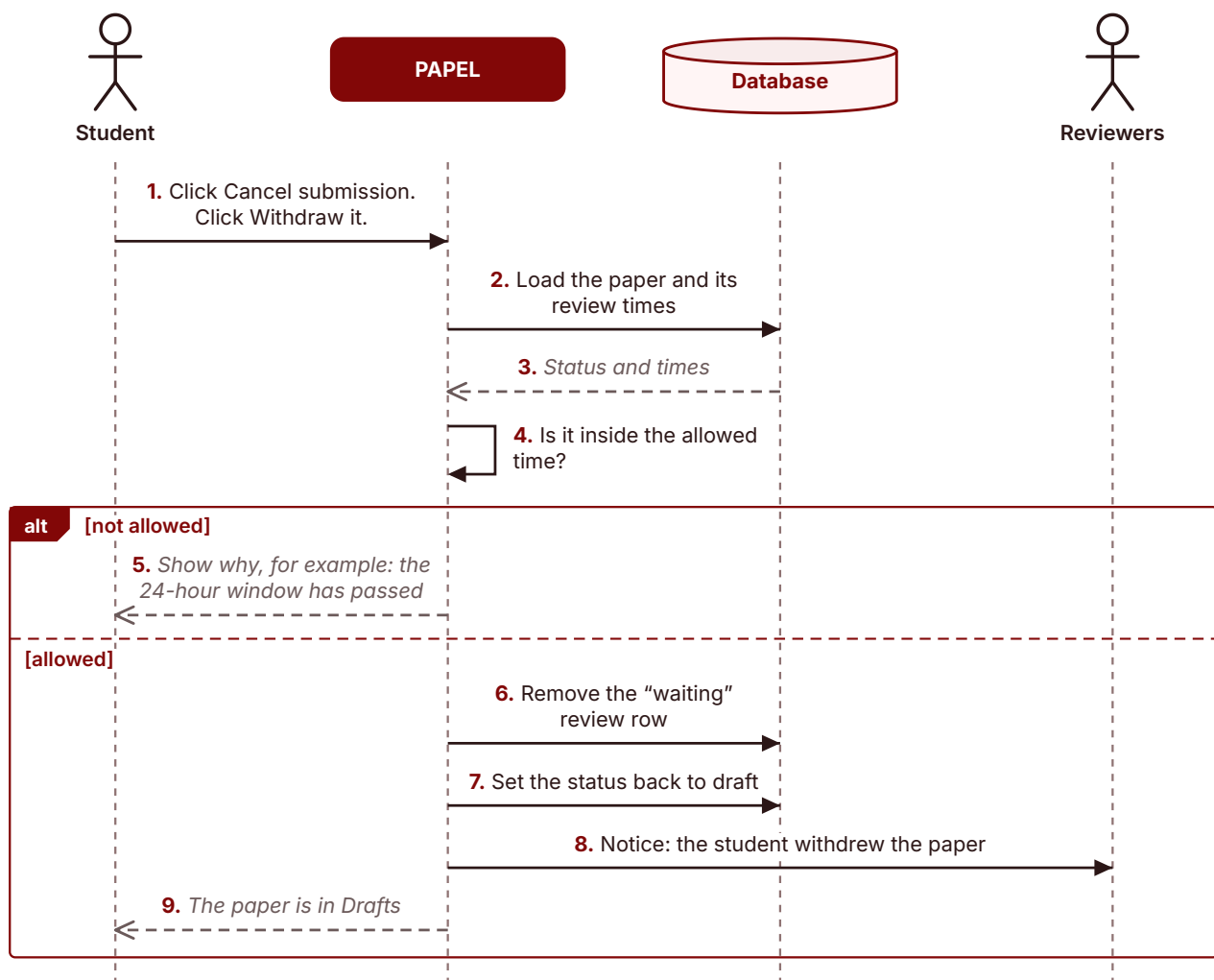
The diagrams for Workflow 5

Figure 5.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

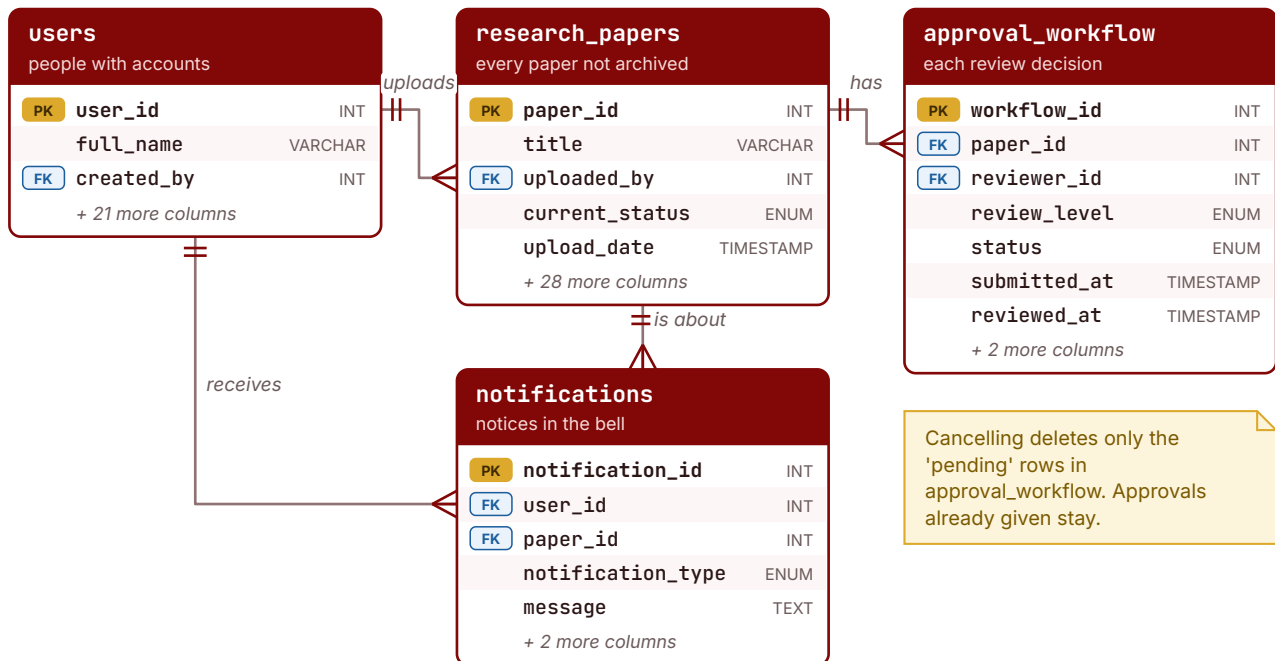
Who does what



What it shows: Cancelling always checks the time window first. If it is allowed, the paper goes back to Drafts and the reviewers are told.

Figure 5.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: PAPEL checks the time again when you click. The button on your screen may be old, so PAPEL does not trust it.

Figure 5.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: Cancelling changes the paper's status and removes any "waiting" review row. Notices go to the reviewers.

WORKFLOW 06 · PART C · REVIEW AND APPROVAL

Review by the Research Adviser

IN SHORT The Research Adviser checks the paper first. They approve it or return it.

Who takes part

Research Adviser

Student

Research Coordinator (gets a notice)

Outside services

Google Drive

Gmail

The Research Adviser works on the **Review Desk**. It has four tabs.

Tab	What is in it
Waiting for you	Papers you must review now.
With Coordinator	Papers you approved. They wait for the Research Coordinator.
Published	Your students' published papers.
Returned	Papers you sent back.

You see papers from **your own students only**: the students whose accounts you made.

Steps: approve a paper

- 1 Open the paper in **Waiting for you**. Read it.
- 2 Click **Approve and forward**. A checklist opens.
- 3 Tick each part the paper has. For example: Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion and References. Or: Chapter 1 to Chapter 5 and References.
- 4 You can leave the **Note for the student** box empty. (Today, no page shows this note to the student.)
- 5 Confirm with **Approve and forward**.
- 6 The paper goes to the Research Coordinator. The Coordinator gets a notice and an email.

Steps: return a paper

- 1 Open the paper. Click **Return with feedback**.
- 2 A box asks **Return this paper?**
- 3 Write **What needs to change**. Be clear, so the student knows what to fix.
- 4 Click **Return to student**.
- 5 The paper goes back to the student. Their dashboard shows it under **Needs Revision**.

- 6 The student gets a notice and an email with your feedback.

Remember

- **Feedback is required** when you return a paper. PAPEL refuses feedback that is empty, looks like random letters, or has rude words.
- When you return a paper, **its files are deleted from Google Drive**. The student must attach the PDF again.
- Your checklist is saved with the paper.
- You can act only on papers that are waiting for you.

Words to know

Approve —Say yes. The paper moves on.

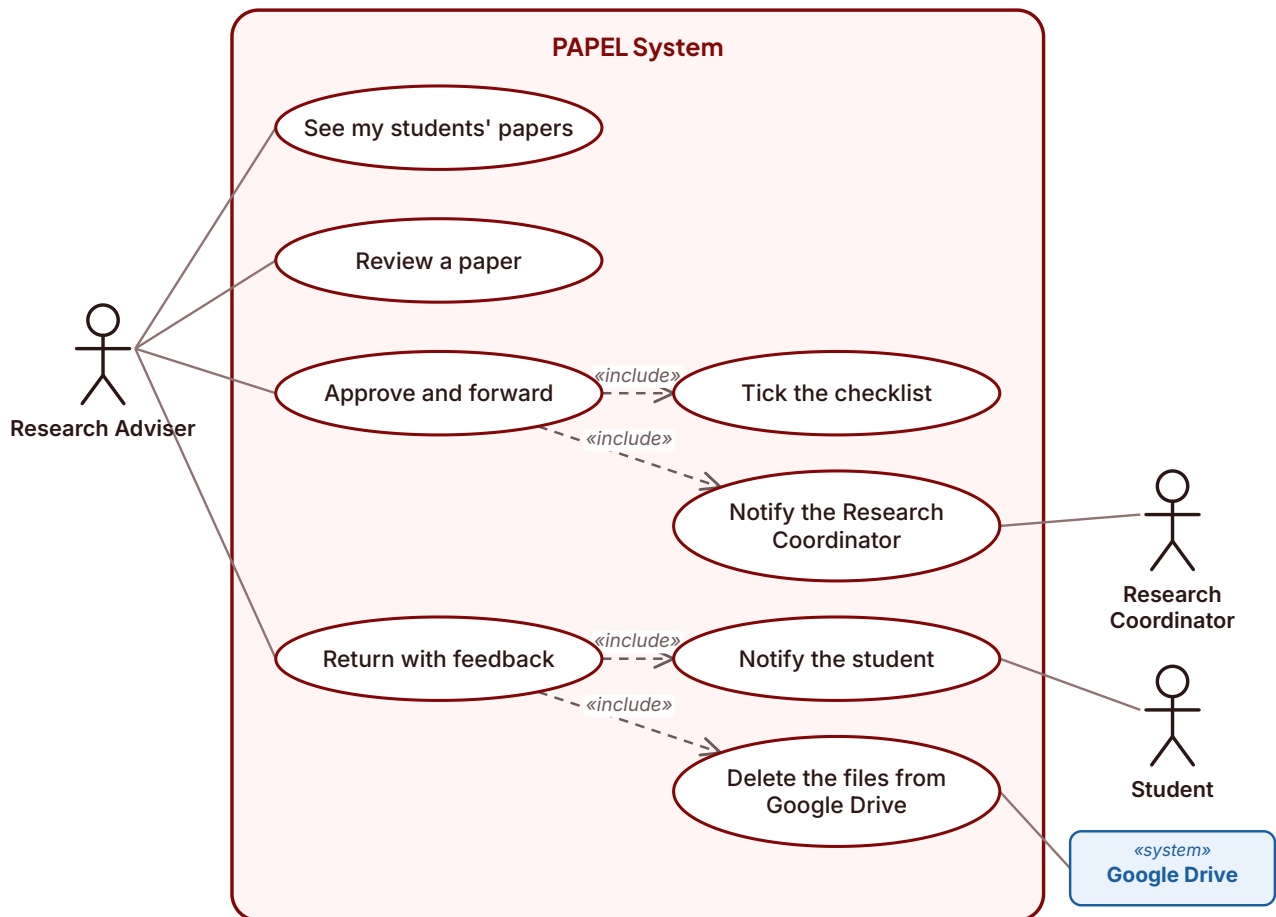
Return —Send the paper back to the student to fix.

Feedback —Your comments about what to change.

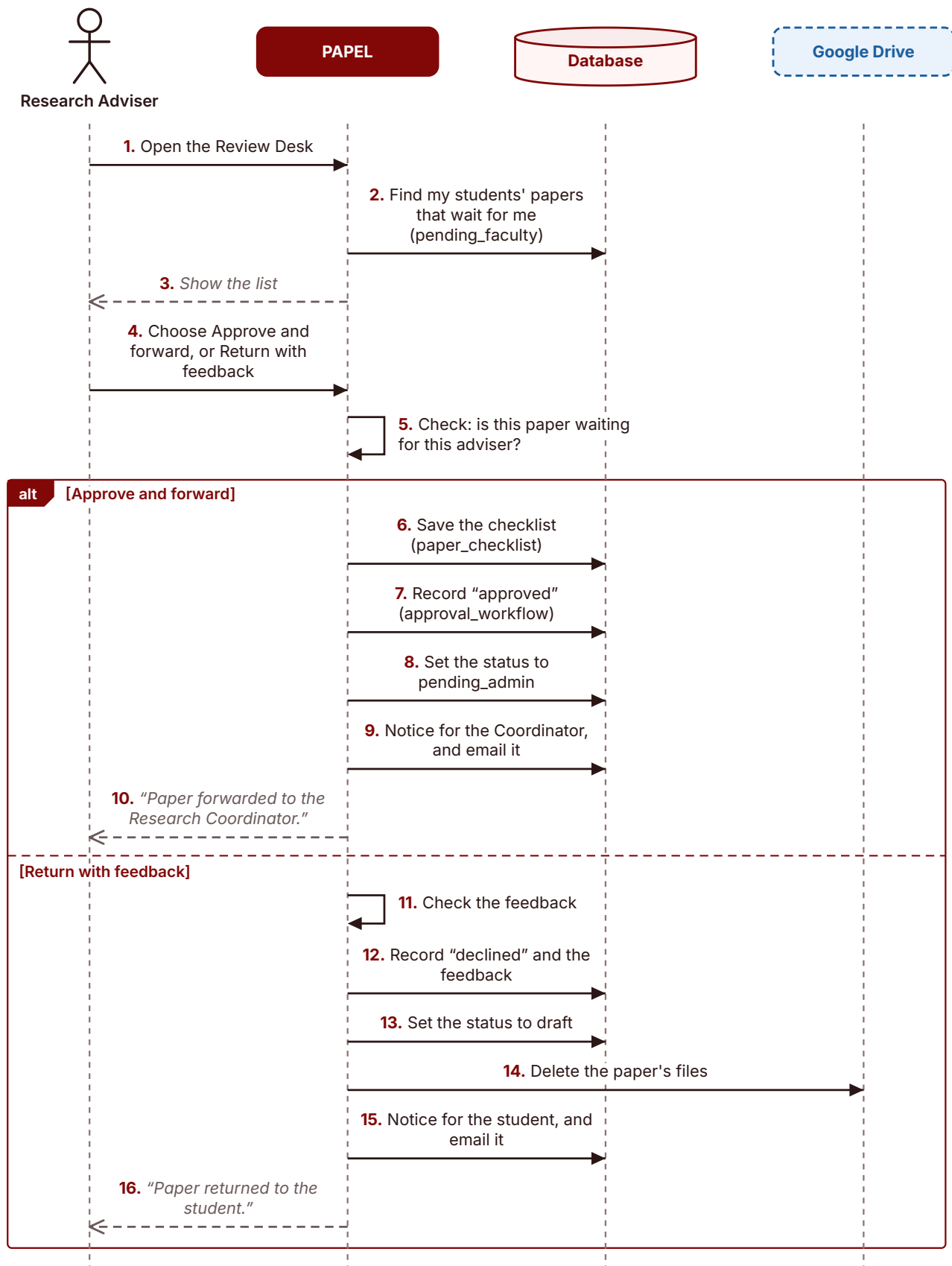
The diagrams for Workflow 6

Figure 6.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

Who does what



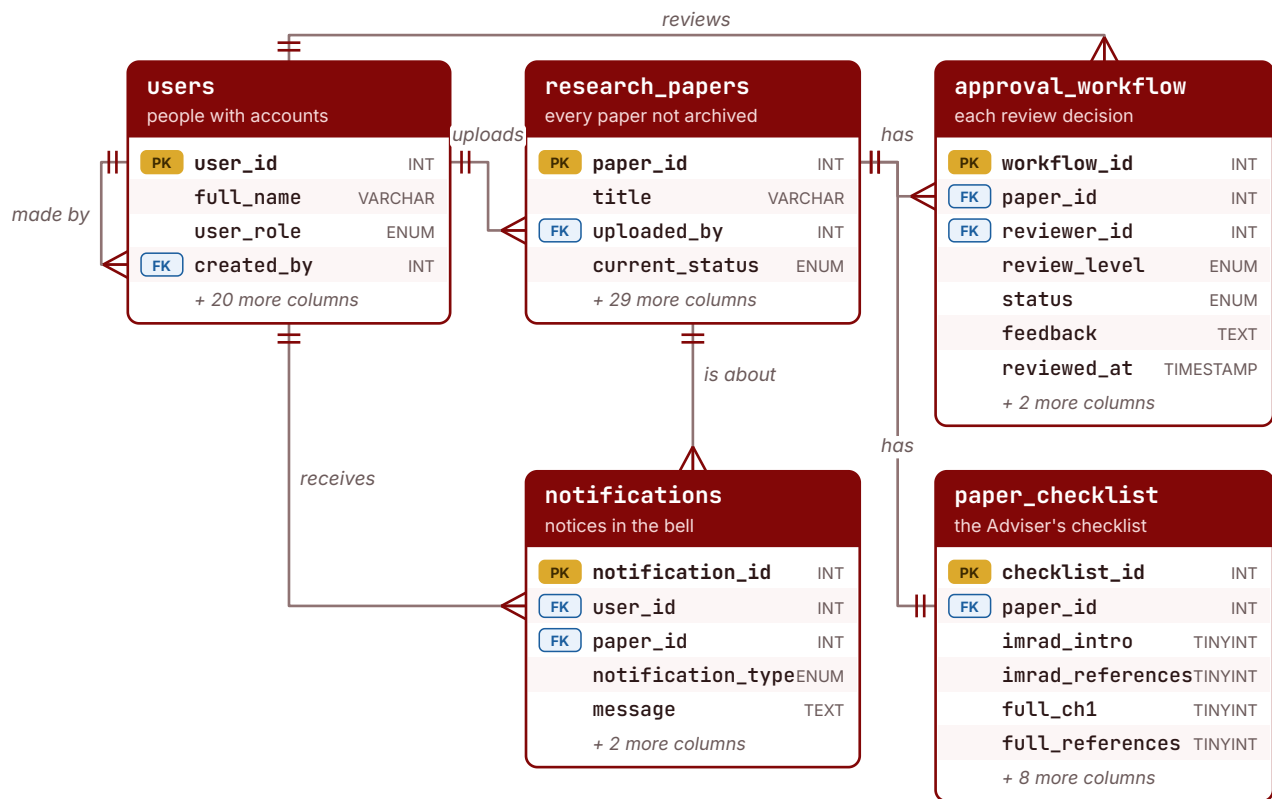
What it shows: The Adviser makes one of two decisions. Approving always saves a checklist and tells the Coordinator. Returning always tells the student and deletes the files from Google Drive.

Figure 6.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: Step 5 is a safety check. A paper can leave this desk only if it belongs to this Adviser's student and is still waiting for this Adviser.

Figure 6.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)

Where the information is saved



What it shows: The Adviser is found through `created_by`: the student's account points to the Adviser who made it. Each decision is a new row in `approval_workflow`. The checklist is one row per paper.

WORKFLOW 07 · PART C · REVIEW AND APPROVAL

Final Review and Publishing

IN SHORT The Research Coordinator makes the final decision. Approving a paper publishes it.

Who takes part

Research Coordinator

Student

Head of Academic Programs and Director (read)

Outside services

Google Drive

Gmail

The Research Coordinator also works on a **Review Desk**. It has four tabs: **Waiting for you**, **With Advisers**, **Published** and **Returned**. The Coordinator sees papers from **all** programs.

Steps: approve and publish

- 1 Open the paper in **Waiting for you**.
- 2 Read the paper and the Adviser's checklist.
- 3 Click **Approve and publish**.
- 4 Confirm with **Approve and publish**. (The **Note for the student** box is not saved at this step.)
- 5 The paper is now **APPROVED**. It shows in the Public Repository at once.
- 6 PAPEL records how many days the paper took, from upload to approval.
- 7 The student gets a notice: the paper is approved and public.

Steps: return a paper

This works the same way as for the Adviser (Workflow 6). Click **Return with feedback**, write **What needs to change**, then click **Return to student**. The files are deleted from Google Drive. The student gets a notice. When the student sends it again, it starts again at the **Research Adviser**.

After publishing: who reads the paper

Who	What they can do with published papers
Head of Academic Programs	Read all published papers. See the Analytics reports. Cannot approve or return.
Director	Read all published papers. Archive a paper (Workflow 12).
Research Adviser	See their own students' published papers.
Everyone	Find the paper in the Public Repository (Workflow 9).

Remember

- **Approving is the last step.** Nobody approves after the Research Coordinator.
- The Coordinator can act only on papers the Adviser has already approved.
- Feedback is required to return a paper.

Words to know

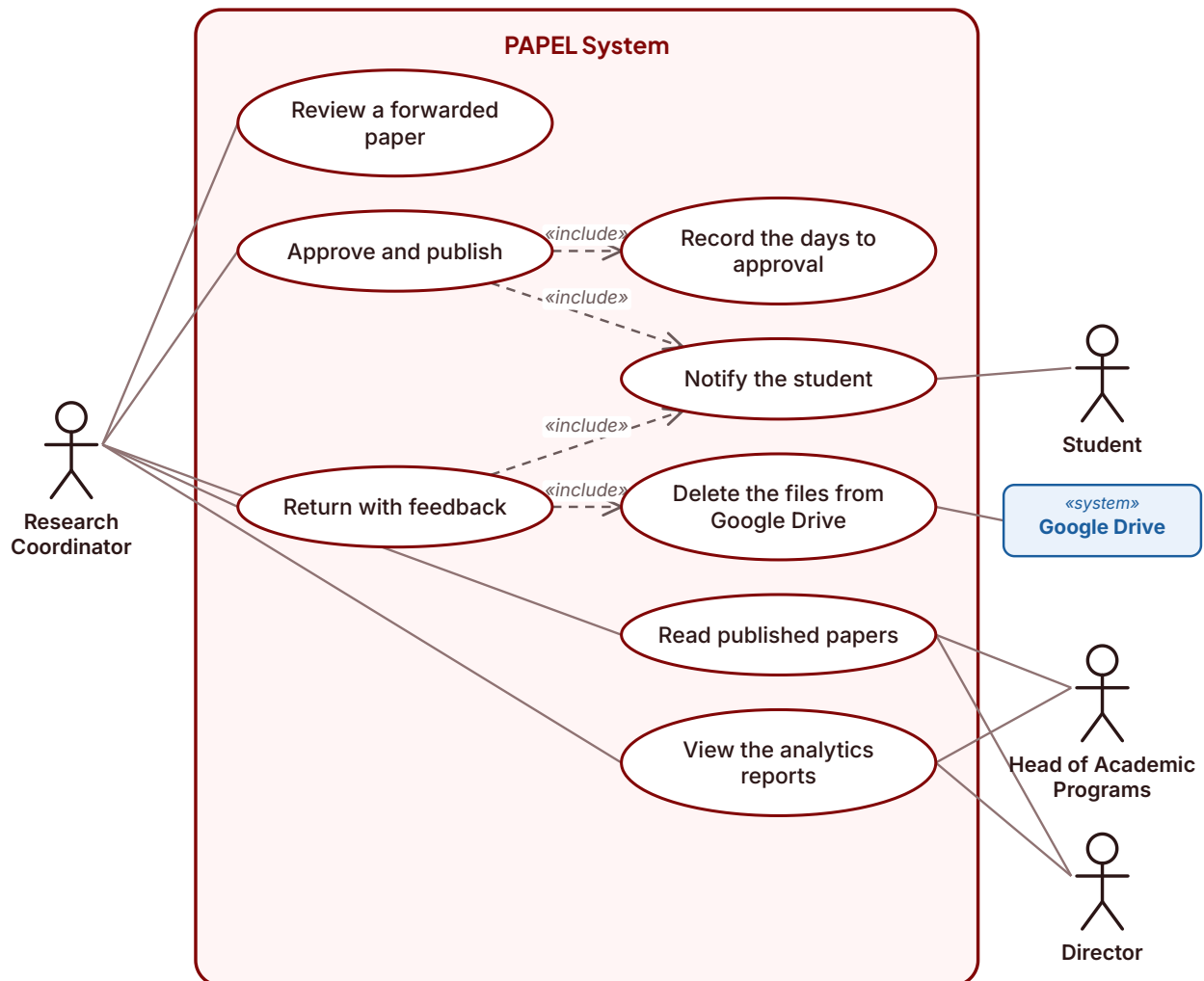
Publish —Make the paper public, so everyone can find it.

Analytics —Reports with numbers and charts about the papers.

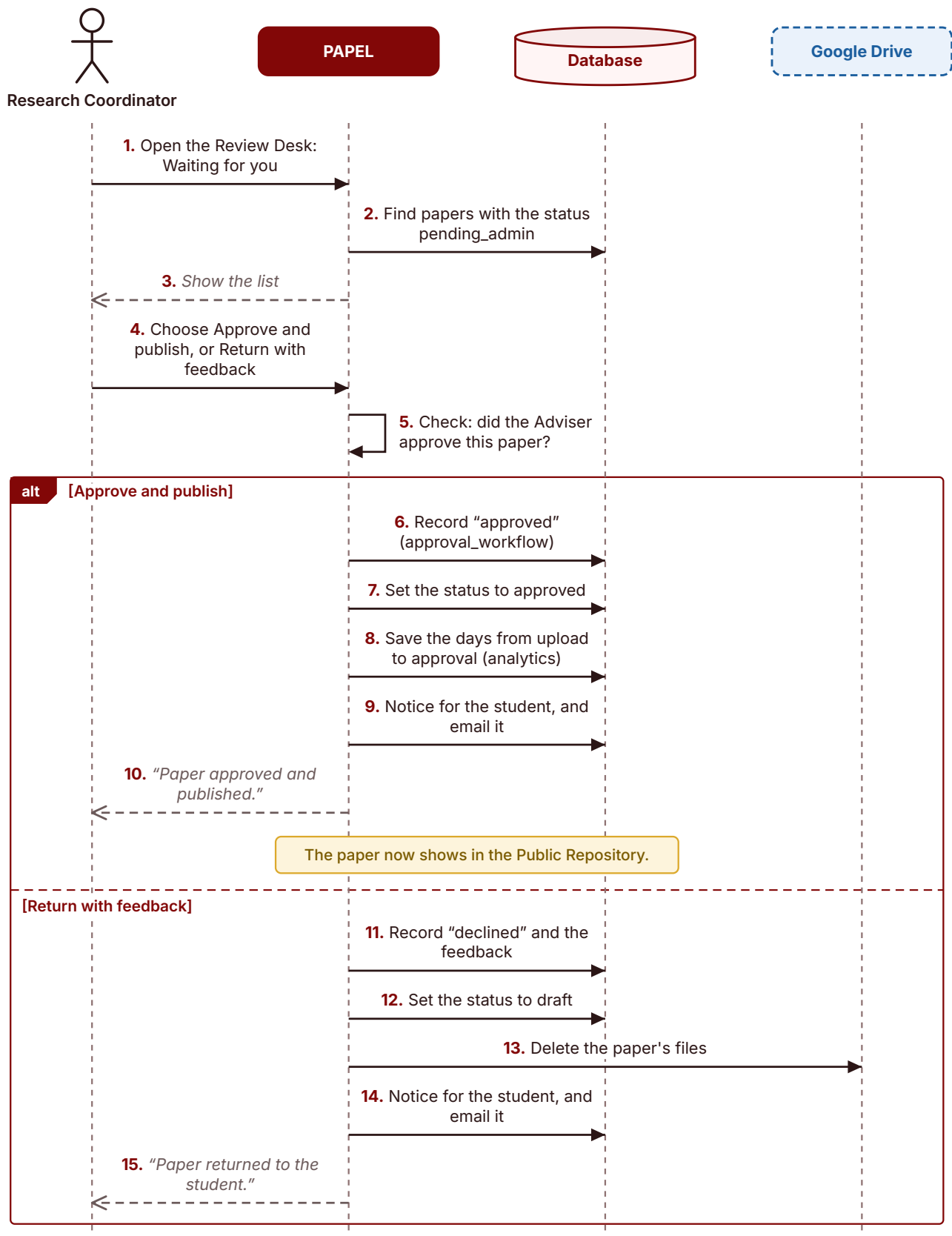
The diagrams for Workflow 7

Figure 7.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

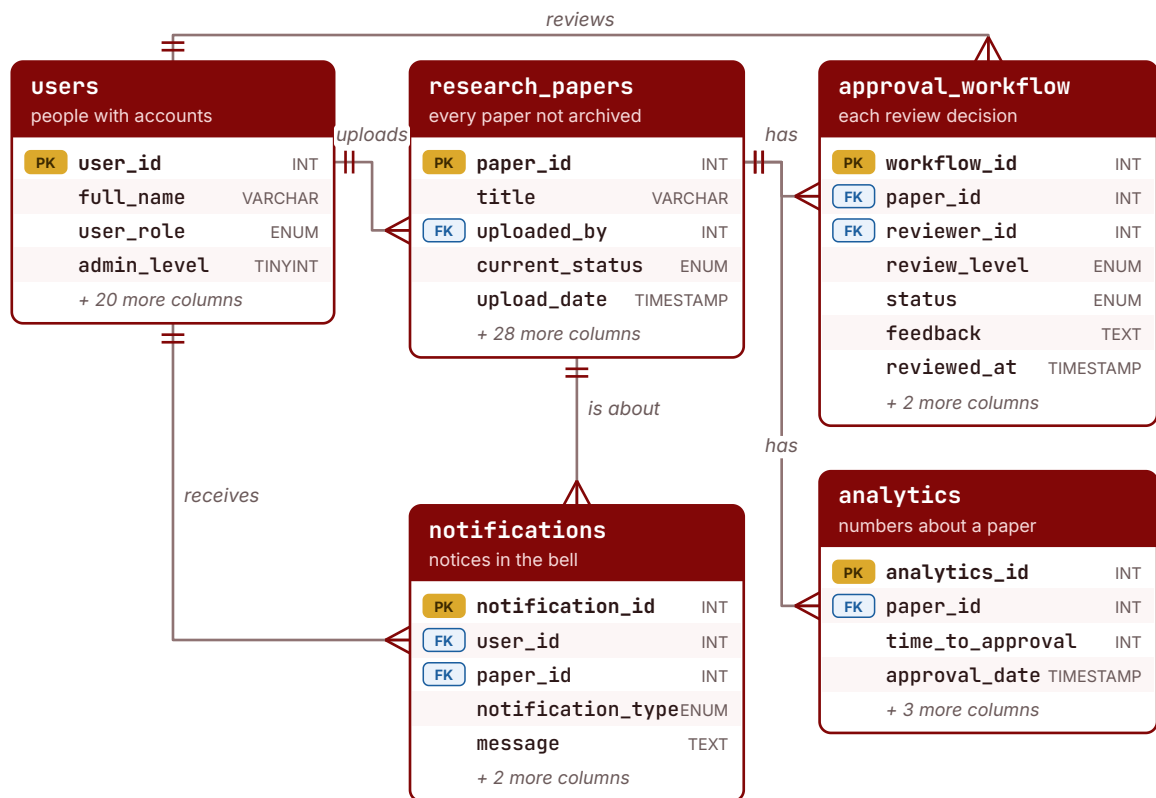
Who does what



What it shows: Only the Coordinator approves and publishes. The Head of Academic Programs and the Director read the results. They have no approve or return button.

Figure 7.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: Publishing is only a change of status. The Public Repository shows every paper with the status "approved", so the paper appears there at once.

Figure 7.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: Publishing sets `current_status` to "approved". The Coordinator's decision is one more row in `approval_workflow`, with `review_level` "admin". `time_to_approval` is the number of days from upload to approval.

WORKFLOW 08 · PART C · REVIEW AND APPROVAL

Fixing a Returned Paper

IN SHORT If a reviewer returns your paper, read the feedback, fix the paper and submit it again.

Who takes part

Student

Research Adviser (gets it again)

Outside services

Google Drive

A returned paper shows in the **Needs Revision** tab of your dashboard. Its badge says **DECLINED**. The card shows **Revision feedback**: the reviewer's words.

Good to know

"Returned" does not mean "rejected forever". It means: please fix it and send it again.

Steps

- 1 Open the **Needs Revision** tab.
- 2 Read the **Revision feedback** carefully.
- 3 Click **Edit and Re-submit**.
- 4 Fix your paper, as the feedback says.
- 5 Attach your PDF again. The old files were deleted from Google Drive when the paper was returned.
- 6 Attach the supporting documents again, if your paper type needs them.
- 7 Click **Submit Paper**.
- 8 The paper goes to your **Research Adviser** again, even if the Research Coordinator was the one who returned it.

Remember

- Old feedback stays on record. Reviewers can see the history.
- You can delete a returned paper if you do not want to continue.
- Nobody can see your changes until you submit again.

Words to know

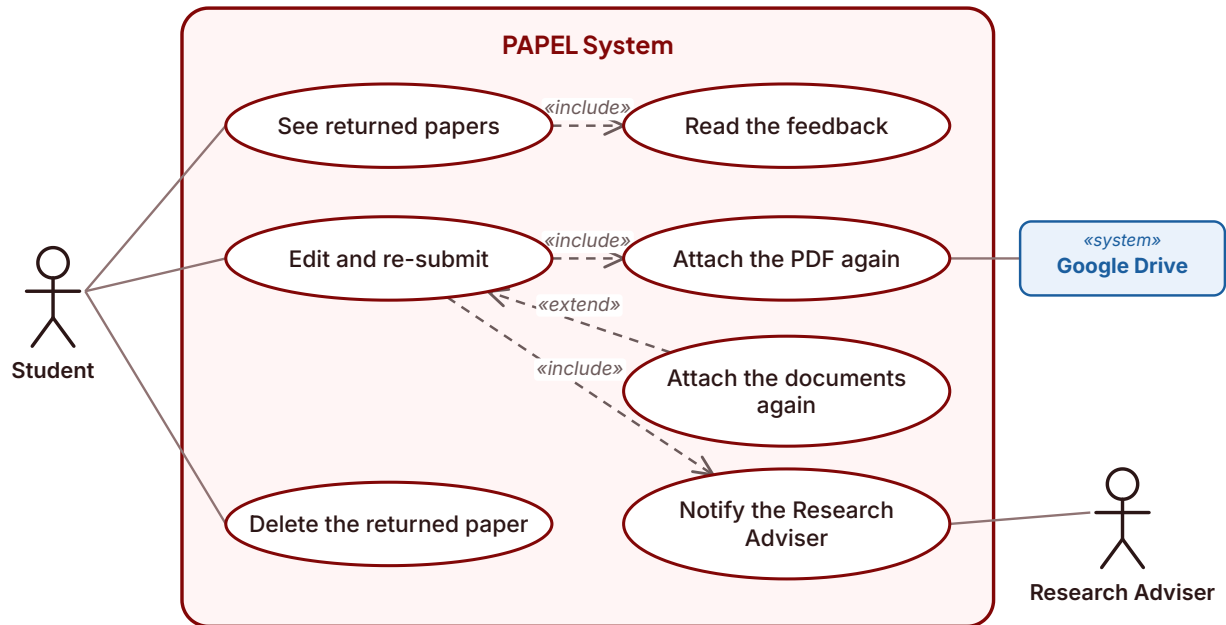
Revision —A change to make your work better.

Re-submit —Send your paper again after fixing it.

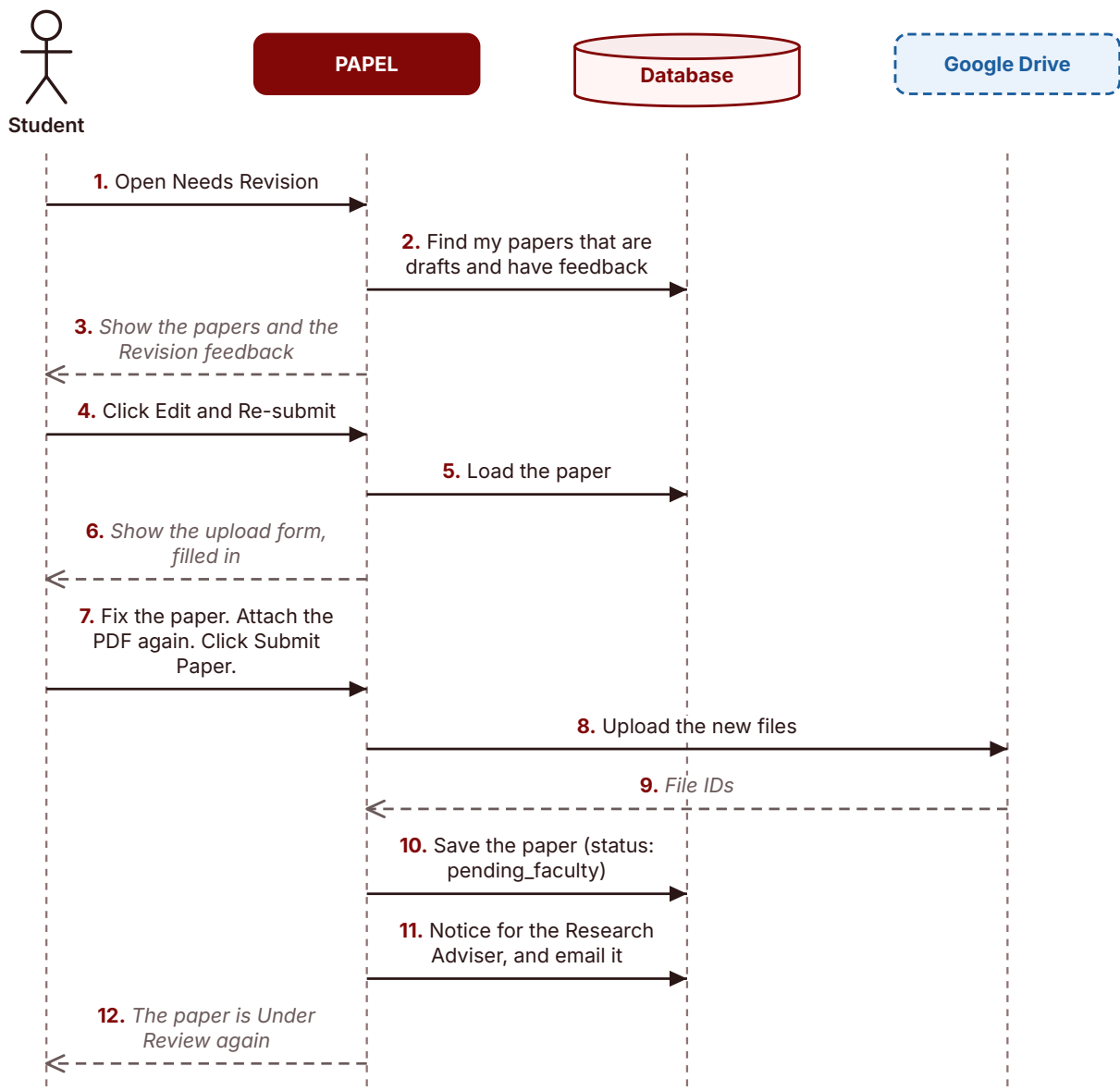
The diagrams for Workflow 8

Figure 8.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

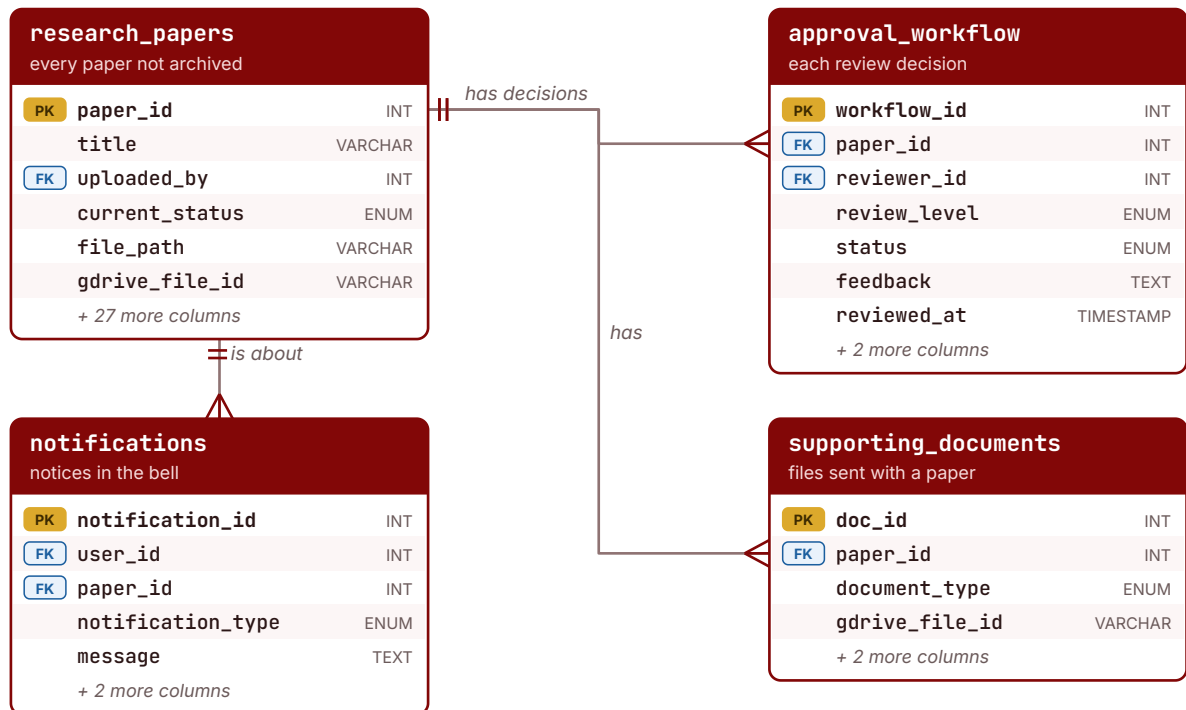
Who does what



What it shows: Fixing a returned paper always means attaching the PDF again. The documents are needed only for some paper types. Sending it again tells the Research Adviser.

Figure 8.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: A returned paper is a draft that has feedback. PAPEL shows it in Needs Revision, not in Drafts, because of that feedback.

Figure 8.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

When a paper is returned, PAPEL deletes its files from Google Drive and sets gdrive_file_id to empty (NULL) in research_papers and supporting_documents. The feedback stays in approval_workflow, in a row with status = 'declined'.

What it shows: The feedback lives in approval_workflow. The empty gdrive_file_id is why the PDF must be attached again.

WORKFLOW 09 · PART D · THE PUBLIC REPOSITORY

Finding and Reading Published Papers

IN SHORT Everyone can search the published papers. To open the details, sign in or use a guest pass.

Who takes part

Visitors

Guests

Students

Staff

Outside services

Groq AI

The **Public Repository** lists every approved paper. Anyone can open it, even without signing in.

Who	See the list	Open the details	Open the full PDF
Visitor (not signed in)	Yes	No: sign in first	No
Guest (with a pass)	Yes	Yes	No
Student	Yes	Yes	Only with a Librarian's permission (Workflow 11)
Staff: Adviser, Coordinator, Head of Academic Programs, Director, Librarian	Yes	Yes	Yes

Steps

- 1 Open the **Public Repository**.
- 2 Type in the search box. PAPEL suggests titles, authors and keywords as you type.
- 3 Use the filters to make the list shorter, for example by paper type, program or year.
- 4 Click a title to open the paper details. If you are not signed in, you see **Login to view details** instead.
- 5 On the details page, read the abstract, the sections and the AI summary.

The **AI summary** gives the methodology, sample size, statistical methods, variables and research field. If a paper has no summary yet, PAPEL makes one with Groq AI the first time someone opens it.

Remember

- Only **approved** papers are in the Public Repository. Drafts and papers under review are never public.
- An archived paper leaves the public list (Workflow 12).
- The AI summary is made by a computer. Always check it against the paper.

Words to know

Repository —A place where things are kept so people can find them.

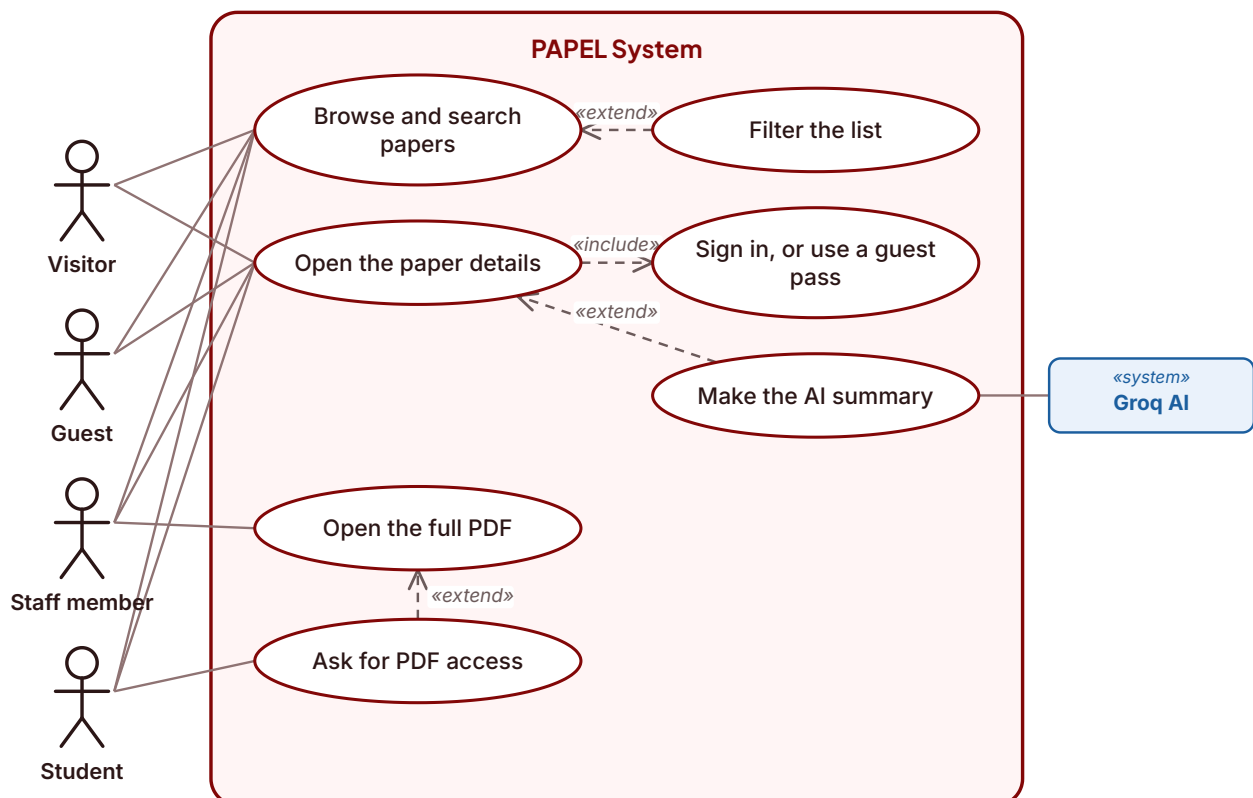
Filter —A choice that hides what you do not need.

Abstract —A short summary at the start of a paper.

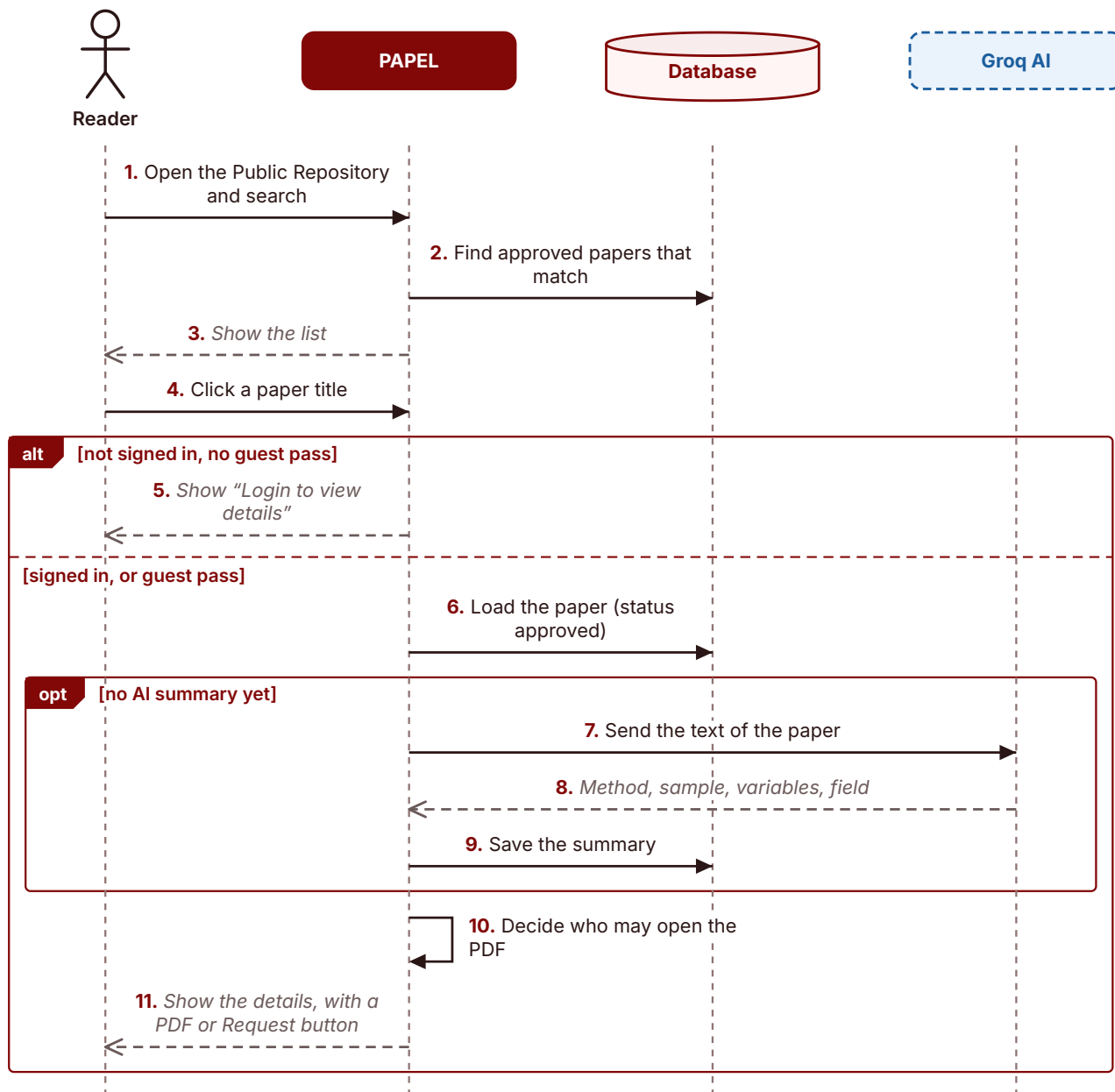
The diagrams for Workflow 9

Figure 9.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

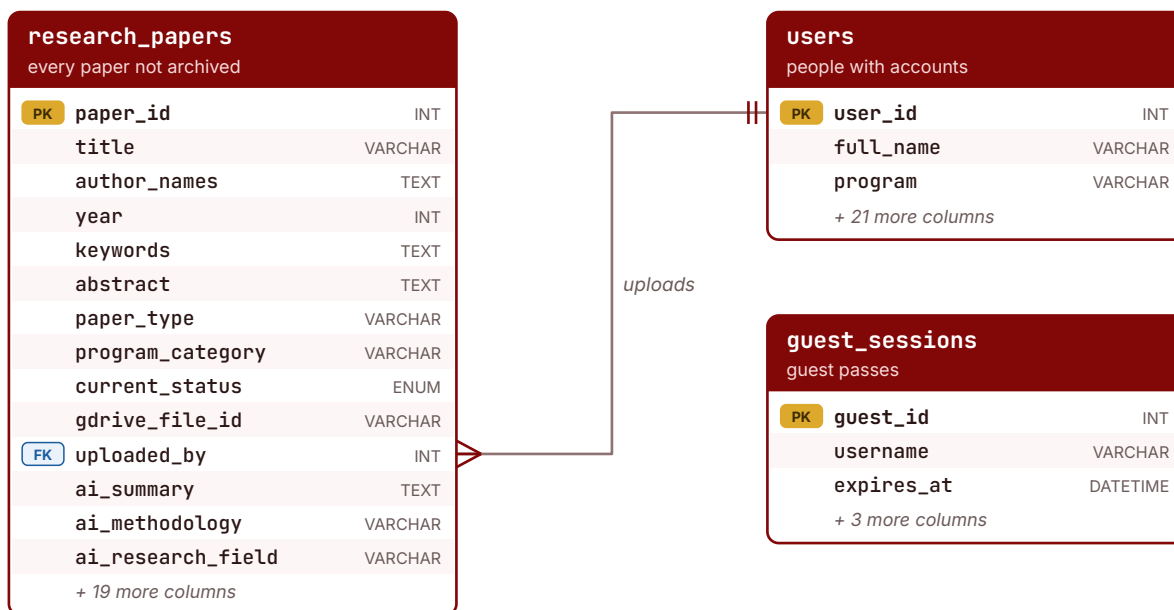
Who does what



What it shows: Anyone can browse. Opening the details needs a sign-in or a guest pass. Staff can open the full PDF. Students can ask for it.

Figure 9.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: Staff see a button to open the PDF. Students see a button to ask for access. Guests see neither.

Figure 9.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

The public list shows only rows where `current_status = 'approved'`. To open the details, a reader needs an account (**users**) or a guest pass (**guest_sessions**). The AI columns (`ai_summary`, `ai_methodology` and the others) are filled the first time the paper is opened, if they are empty.

What it shows: The Public Repository reads **research_papers**, but only the approved rows.

WORKFLOW 10 · PART D · THE PUBLIC REPOSITORY

Guest Passes

IN SHORT A Librarian gives a visitor a pass that works for a few hours.

Who takes part

Librarian

Guest

Outside services

Gmail

A guest is a visitor without a PAPEL account. A guest pass lets them read paper details for a short time. The Research Coordinator and the Director can also open this page.

Steps: the Librarian makes a pass

- 1 Open **Guest Passes**.
- 2 Type the guest's email address.
- 3 Choose how long the pass works: **1, 2, 4, 8, 12 or 24 hours**.
- 4 Create the pass.
- 5 PAPEL checks that the email does not belong to a PAPEL account.
- 6 PAPEL makes a username, like `guest_3fa9c21b`, and a 12-character password.
- 7 PAPEL emails them to the guest. You can also see them on the screen.

Steps: the guest signs in

- 1 Open the email from PAPEL.
- 2 Go to PAPEL and click **Sign In**.
- 3 Choose the **Guest** tab.
- 4 Type the username and the password.
- 5 Read the Public Repository.
- 6 When the time ends, PAPEL signs you out.

Remember

- A guest can read paper details. A guest **cannot** open the full PDF.
- A pass cannot be made for an email that already has a PAPEL account, even if it is written differently, for example with a dot or a "+" in a Gmail address. That person signs in with their own account.
- A pass cannot be made longer. To give more time, make a new pass.
- The Librarian can delete a pass early. Nobody can sign in with it after that.
- The password is easy to read out loud. It never uses the letters l, I, O or the number 0.
- Expired passes are listed apart. The Librarian can clear them.

Words to know

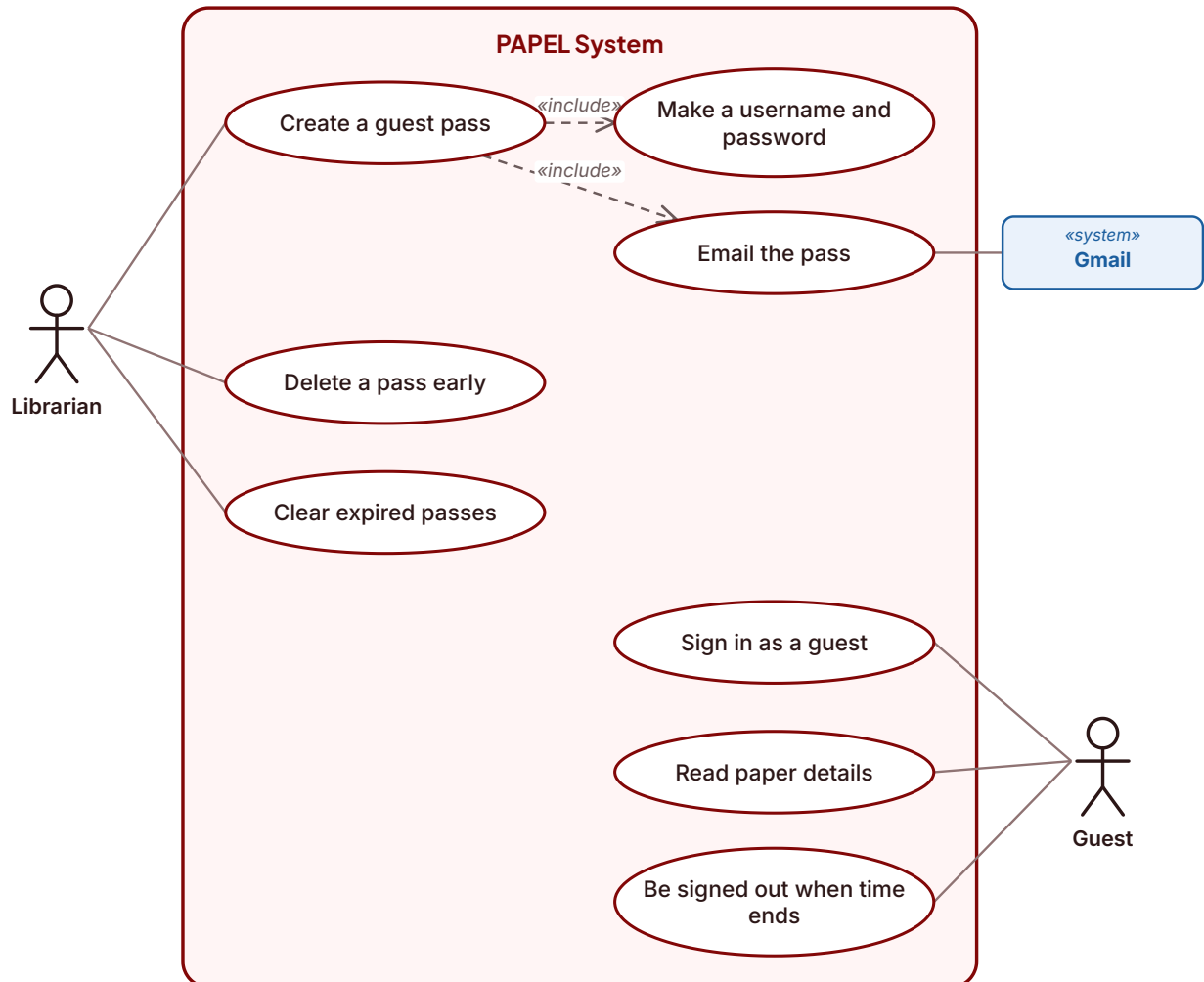
Guest —A visitor without a PAPEL account.

Pass —A username and password that work for a short time.

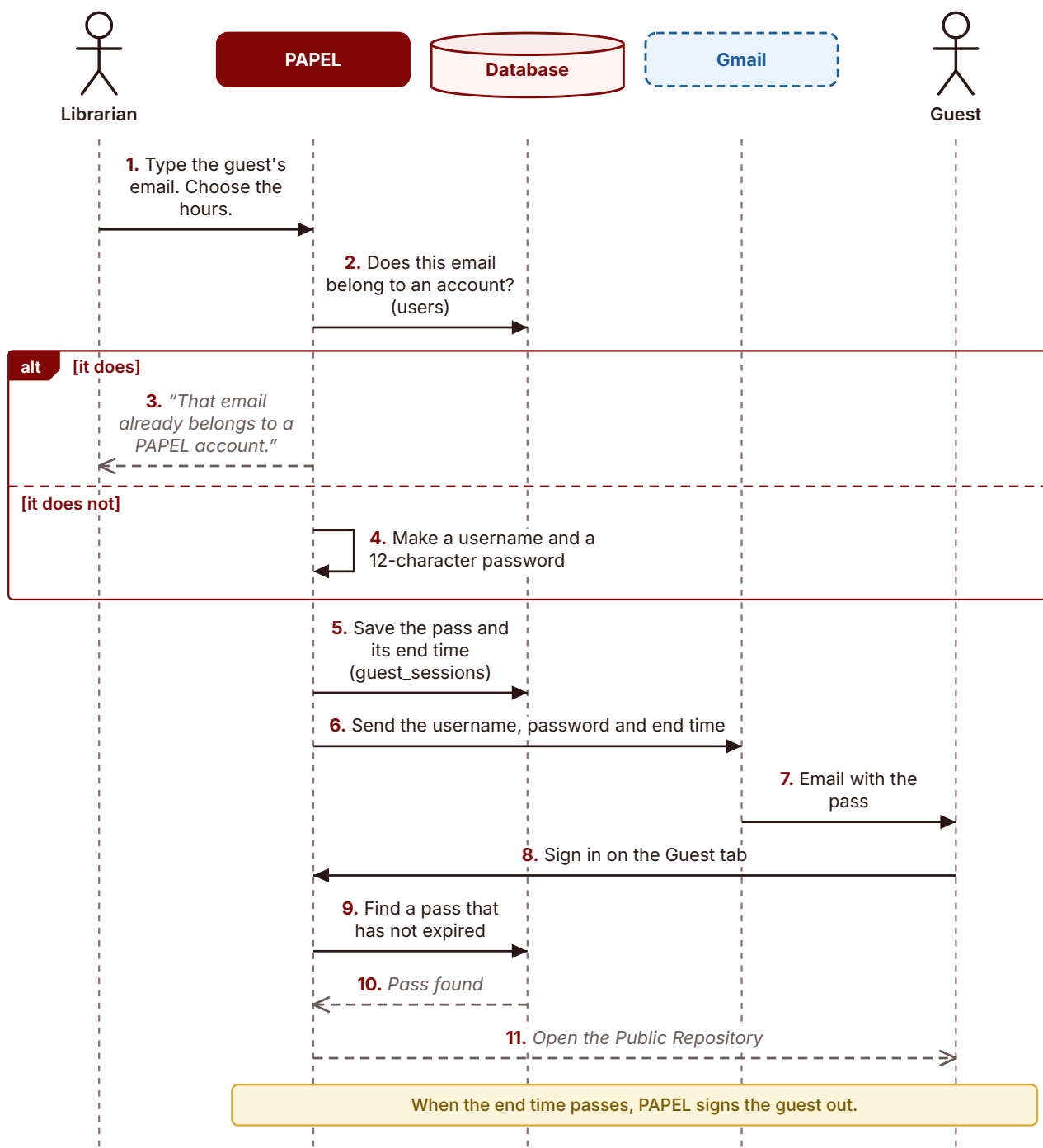
The diagrams for Workflow 10

Figure 10.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

Who does what



What it shows: The Librarian creates and removes passes. The guest signs in, reads, and is signed out when the time is up.

Figure 10.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: A guest is not a user account. PAPEL keeps the pass in its own table and checks its end time at every page.

Figure 10.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

guest_sessions		
guest passes		
PK	guest_id	INT
	username	VARCHAR
	password	VARCHAR
	plain_password	VARCHAR
	created_at	DATETIME
	expires_at	DATETIME

login_attempts		
wrong sign-in tries		
PK	scope	VARCHAR
	attempts	INT
	first_at	DATETIME
	last_at	DATETIME
	locked_until	DATETIME

guest_sessions is not linked to users: a guest is not an account. password is stored scrambled (hashed), and sign-in checks it. plain_password is kept on purpose, so the Librarian can read the pass out again. A pass stops working when expires_at has passed. No scheduled task is needed for that.

login_attempts counts wrong sign-in tries for guest usernames too. scope holds the ID that was typed and the address of the computer.

What it shows: Guest passes live in their own table. They are not linked to the users table.

WORKFLOW 11 · PART D · THE PUBLIC REPOSITORY

Asking to Open a Full Manuscript

IN SHORT A student asks a Librarian for permission to open a paper's PDF. The Librarian allows it for a few hours, or says no.

Who takes part

Student

Librarian

Students can read the details of every published paper. The full PDF is for staff only. A student who needs the PDF can ask for it.

Steps: the student asks

- 1 Open the paper details.
- 2 Go to the manuscript part of the page.
- 3 Click **Request manuscript access**.
- 4 A message says **Request sent. A librarian will review it shortly**.
- 5 Wait for a notice.

Steps: the Librarian answers

- 1 Open **Manuscript Requests**.
- 2 Look at the waiting requests.
- 3 To allow it: choose how long, from **1 to 24 hours**, and click **Grant**.
- 4 To refuse it: click **Deny**.
- 5 The student gets a notice either way.

Remember

- Access ends by itself when the time is up.
- A student can have **up to 3** manuscripts open at the same time.
- A student cannot ask again for the same paper while a request is waiting, or while access is still open.
- If a request was denied, or the access has ended, the student can ask again.
- Deleting a granted request ends the access at once.
- Every Librarian gets a notice when a student asks.

Words to know

Manuscript —The full text of the paper, as a PDF file.

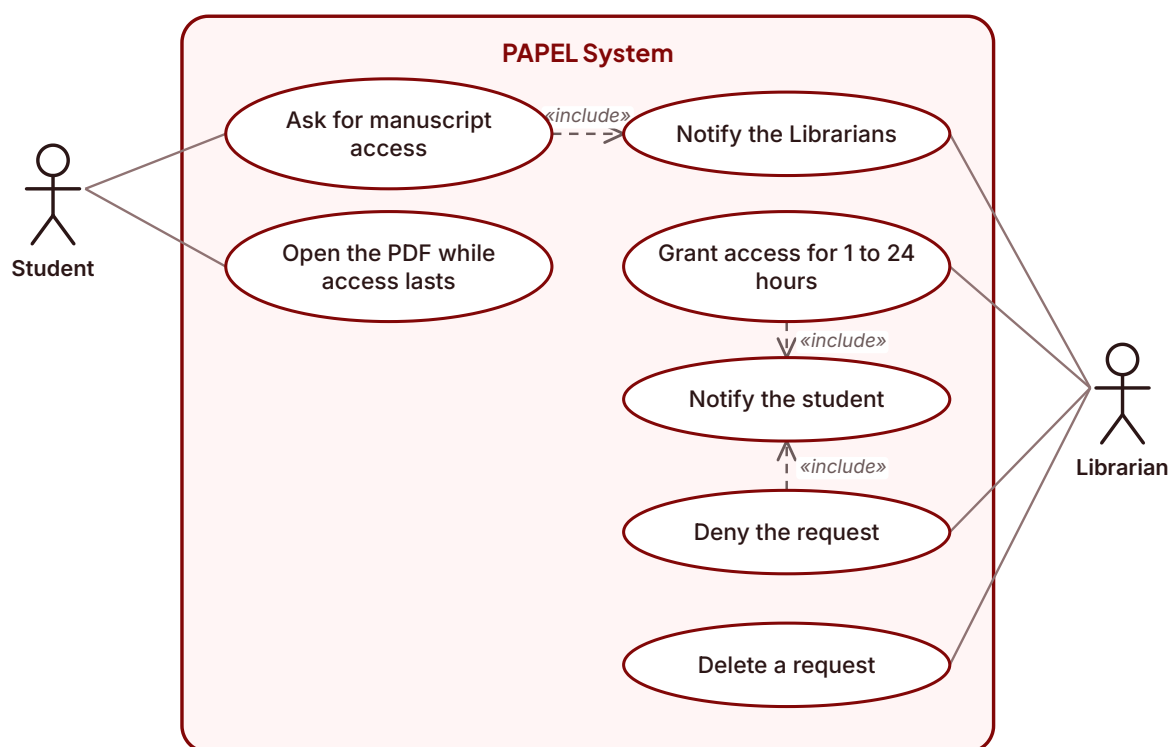
Grant —Give permission.

Deny —Say no.

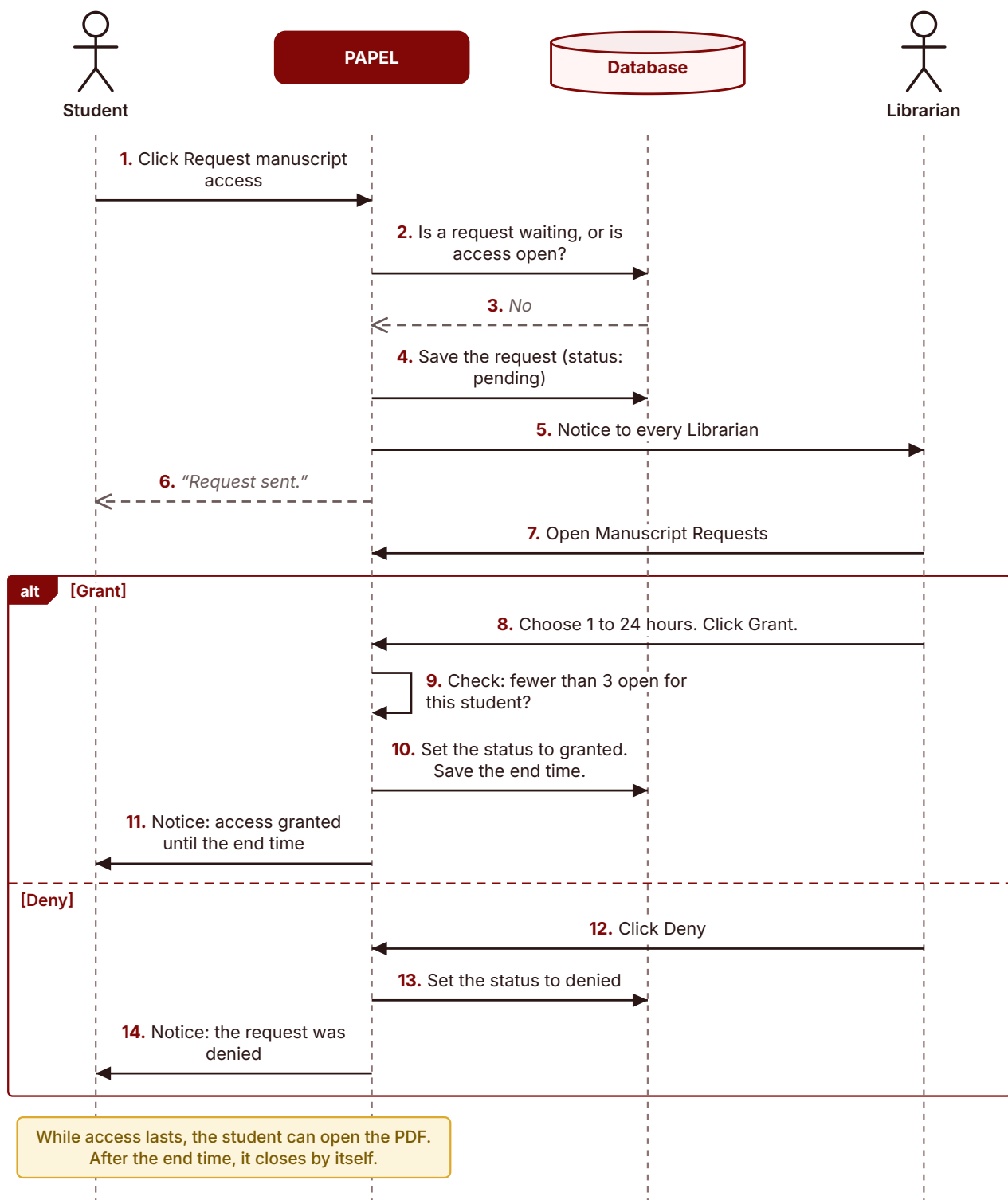
The diagrams for Workflow 11

Figure 11.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

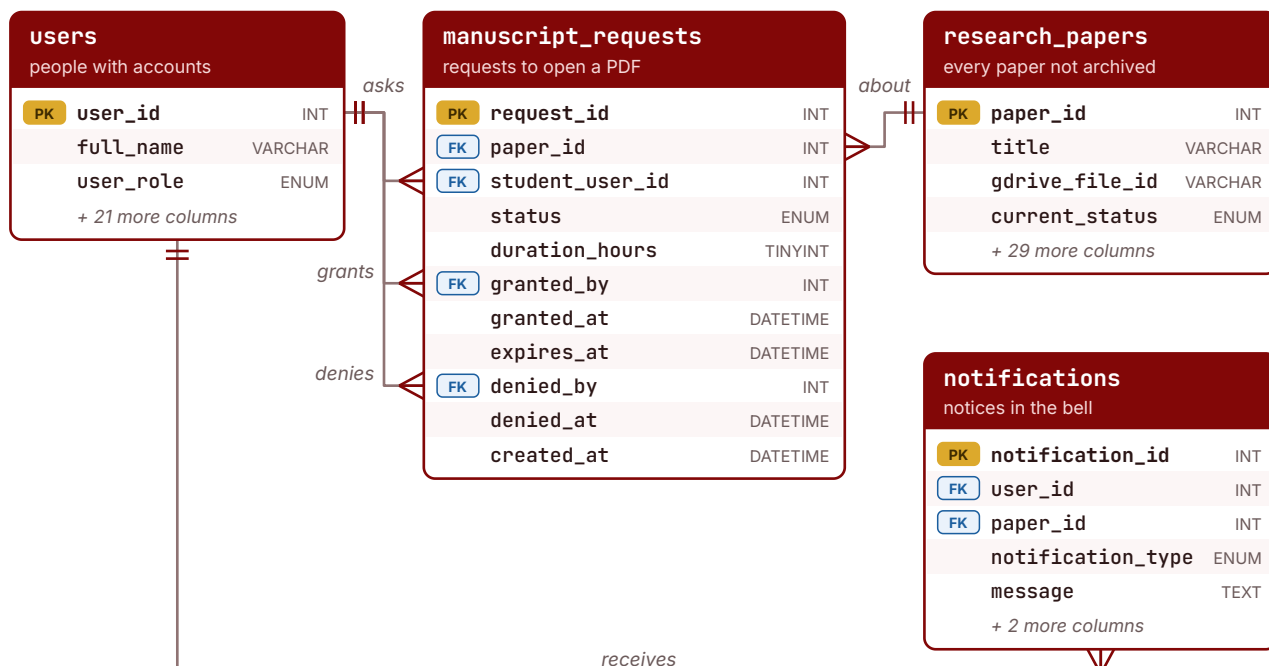
Who does what



What it shows: The student asks. Every Librarian is told. A Librarian grants or denies, and the student is told the answer.

Figure 11.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: Nothing needs to run when the time is up. PAPEL simply stops counting a grant after its end time.

Figure 11.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: One request links three things: the student who asked, the paper, and the Librarian who answered. `expires_at` is the end of the access.

WORKFLOW 12 · PART E · RECORDS AND HELP

Archiving a Paper

IN SHORT The Director can move a published paper out of the Public Repository and into the archive.

Who takes part

Director

The automatic 5-year task

Archiving is a records decision. It is not part of the review. The paper is **not deleted**. PAPEL keeps it safely in the archive record.

Steps: the Director archives a paper

- 1 Open **My Dashboard**. It lists all published papers.
- 2 Find the paper.
- 3 Click **Archive**.
- 4 A box asks **Archive this paper?** Click **Archive it**. (Click **Leave it published** to stop.)
- 5 PAPEL copies the whole paper into the archive.
- 6 PAPEL removes the paper from the list of active papers.
- 7 The paper no longer shows in the Public Repository.

The 5-year rule

PAPEL has a task that archives a published paper by itself when it is more than 5 years old (1,825 days after upload). **This task runs only if the system team schedules it to run every day.**

Remember

- Only published (approved) papers can be archived.
- The archive keeps every part of the paper: the text, the sections, the file link and the details.
- The paper's files stay in Google Drive.
- Archived papers still appear in the reports, marked **Archived**.
- There is **no Restore button** on the screen. To bring a paper back, ask the system team. PAPEL has a restore function that returns the paper with the status it had.

Words to know

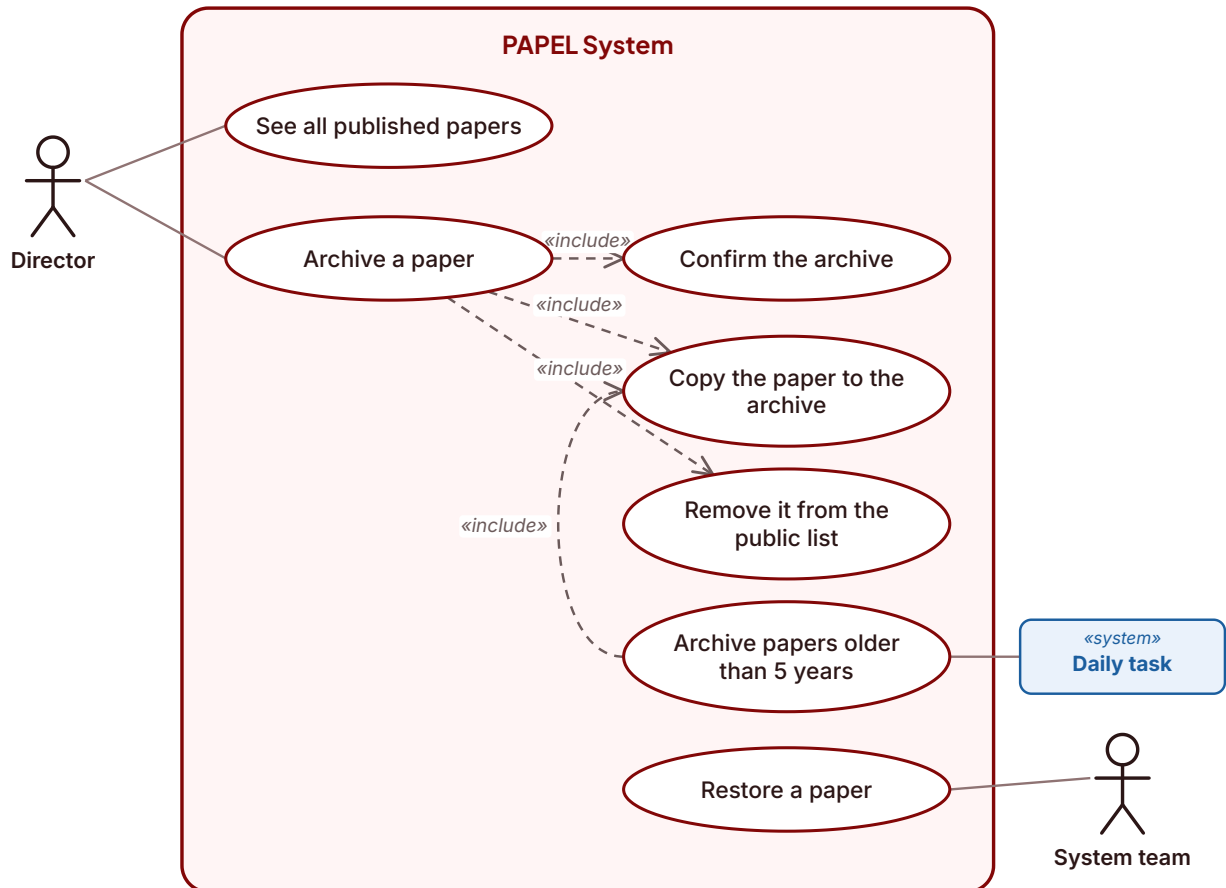
Archive —A safe place for old records. They are kept, but not shown.

Restore —Bring something back to where it was.

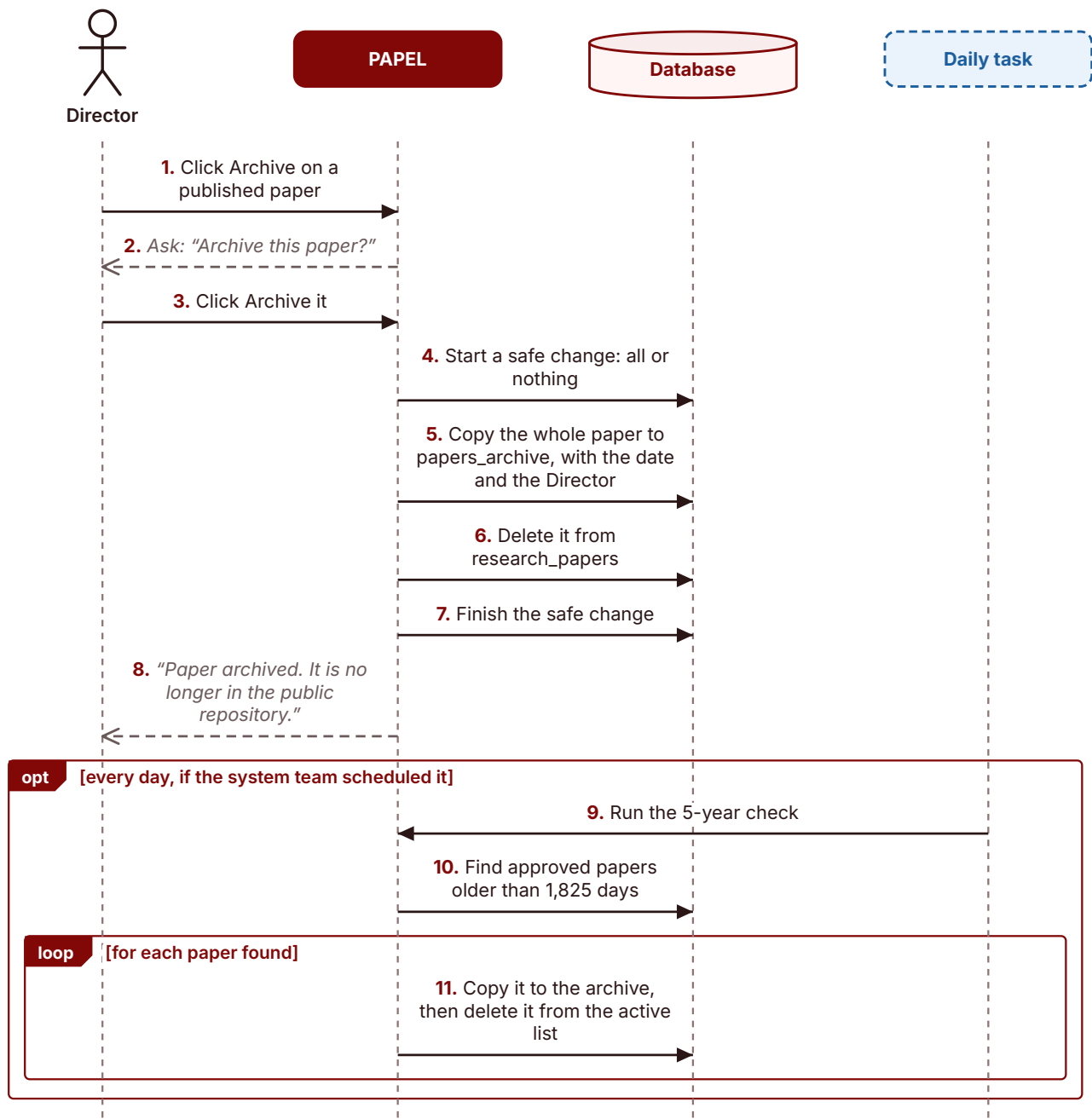
The diagrams for Workflow 12

Figure 12.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

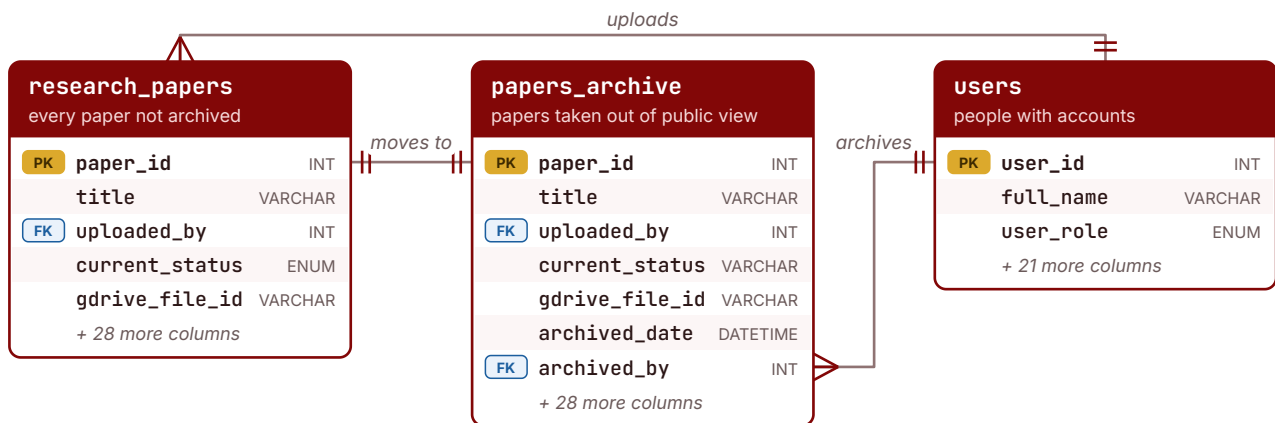
Who does what



What it shows: The Director archives one paper at a time. A daily task can archive old papers, if the system team sets it up. Only the system team can restore.

Figure 12.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: Copying and deleting happen together, as one safe step. If one part fails, neither happens. So a paper can never be lost halfway.

Figure 12.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

papers_archive has the same columns as research_papers, plus archived_date and archived_by. Archiving copies the row, then deletes it from research_papers, as one safe step (a transaction). Rows in approval_workflow, paper_checklist and supporting_documents stay behind, as history. archived_by = 0 means the automatic 5-year task did it.

What it shows: A paper is in research_papers or in papers_archive, never in both. The paper keeps the same paper_id when it moves.

WORKFLOW 13 · PART E · RECORDS AND HELP

Notifications and Emails

IN SHORT PAPEL tells people when something happens. Each notice appears in the bell and is also sent by email.

Who takes part

Everyone with an account

Outside services

Gmail

The bell at the top of the page shows your new notices. **Notifications** opens the full list.

When this happens	Who gets a notice
A student submits a paper	Their Research Adviser
The Adviser approves it	The Research Coordinator
The Coordinator approves and publishes it	The student
A reviewer returns a paper	The student, with the feedback
A student cancels a submission	The reviewers of that paper
A student asks for a manuscript	Every Librarian
A Librarian grants or denies it	The student
An account, password or support event	The person it is about

PAPEL also sends each notice to the person's email, through Gmail. If the email fails, the notice in the bell is still there.

Steps

- 1 Click the bell at the top of the page.
- 2 Read your newest notices.
- 3 To see all of them, open **Notifications**.
- 4 Mark all as read, or delete the ones you do not need.

Reminders

PAPEL can remind reviewers about papers that wait for them, at **10:00** and **15:30**. This works only if the system team schedules the reminder task, and only for people who have a reminder time set.

Remember

- A failed email never stops the work. The notice is saved first.
- Check your email spam folder if you do not see PAPEL emails.

Words to know

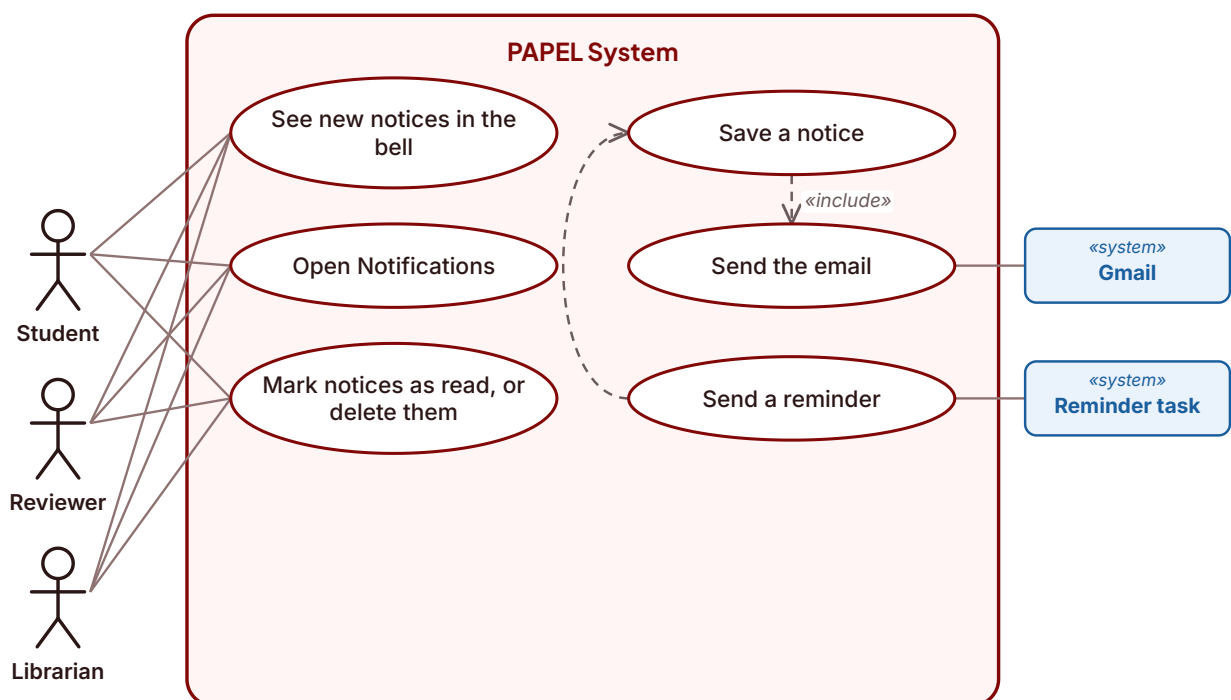
Notice —A short message from PAPEL about something that happened.

Reminder —A message that tells you something is still waiting.

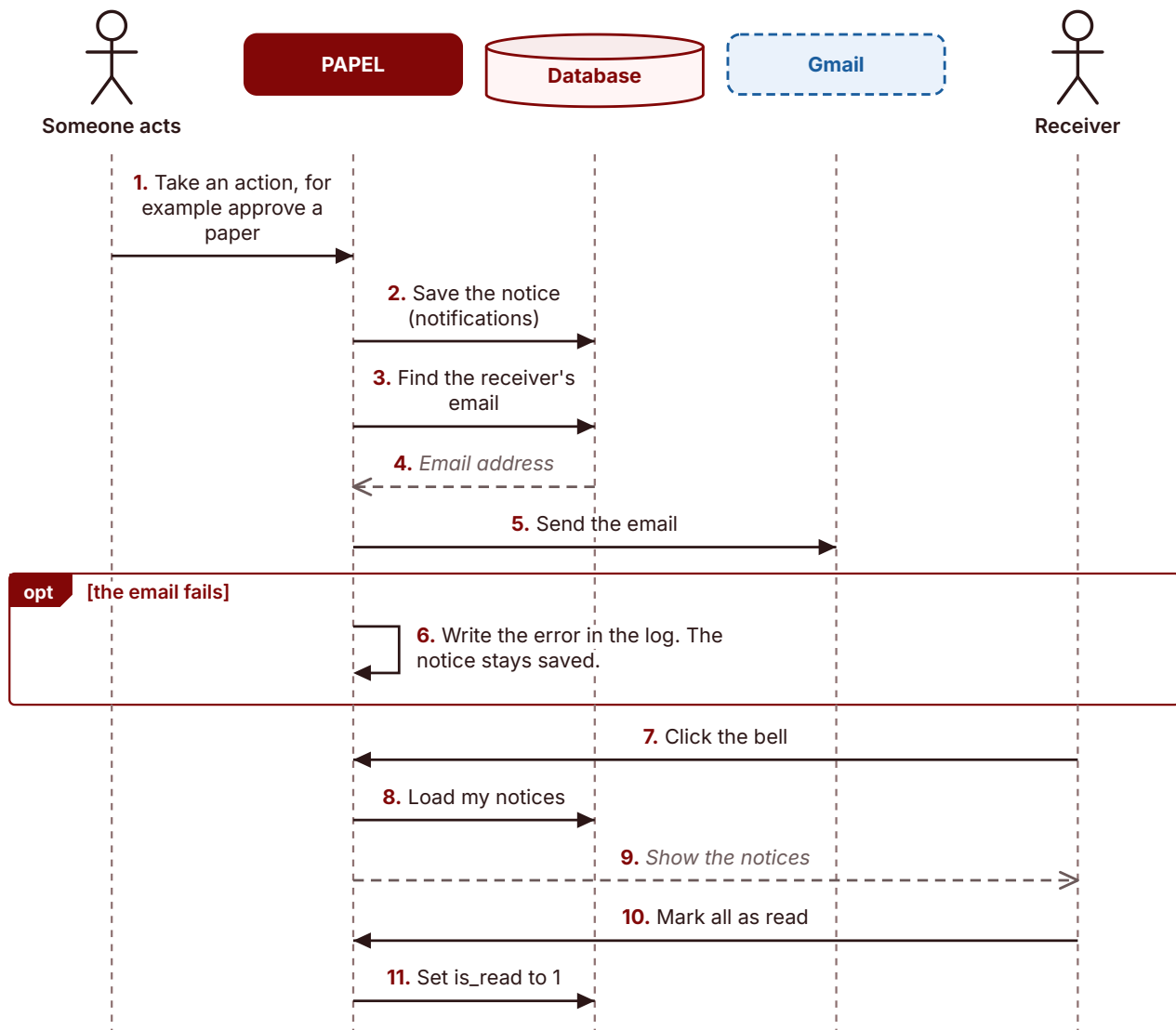
The diagrams for Workflow 13

Figure 13.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

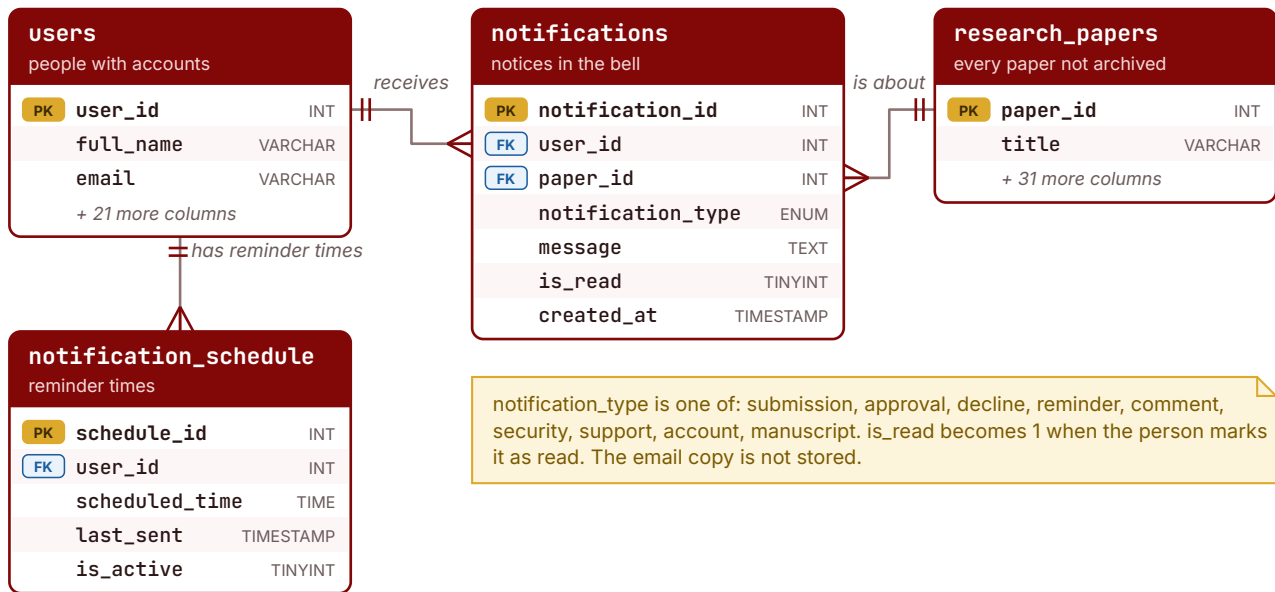
Who does what



What it shows: "Save a notice" is used by many other workflows, for example when a paper is approved. Every saved notice is also sent by email.

Figure 13.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The notice is saved before the email is sent. So a problem with email never loses a notice.

Figure 13.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

What it shows: Each notice belongs to one user and may be about one paper. Reminder times are in notification_schedule.

WORKFLOW 14 · PART E · RECORDS AND HELP

Getting Help with an Account

IN SHORT If you forgot your password or your account is wrong, send a request. It goes to the person who made your account.

Who takes part

Anyone

Research Adviser, Research Coordinator or Director (handle requests)

Outside services

Gmail

Open **Contact Support**. Choose a topic.

Topic	What happens
Forgotten Password	A request goes to the person who made your account.
Account Issue	For example, a wrong name or email. A request goes to the person who made your account.
Other topics	The message goes to the PAPEL support mailbox.

If you are a...	Your request goes to...
Student	Your Research Adviser
Research Adviser or Librarian	The Research Coordinator or the Director
Research Coordinator or Head of Academic Programs	The Director

Steps: ask for help

- 1 Open **Contact Support**.
- 2 Type your name, your email and your ID.
- 3 Choose **Forgotten Password** or **Account Issue**.
- 4 Choose who should handle it, if PAPEL asks.
- 5 Write your message and send it.
- 6 PAPEL tells you who got your request.

Steps: handle a request

- 1 Open **Support Requests**. It lists requests from the people whose accounts you made.
- 2 Open the account on your own page: **My Students**, **Manage Faculty** or **Manage Admins**.
- 3 Reset the password, or fix the details.

- 4 PAPEL clears the request by itself and emails the person.
- 5 If you solved it in another way, for example in person, click **Done**.

Remember

- The Director sees **all** requests. The Director can help when a request goes to the wrong person.
- Librarians do not handle support requests.
- A new password shows on the handler's screen one time. Change it after you sign in.
- PAPEL records every password change.

Words to know

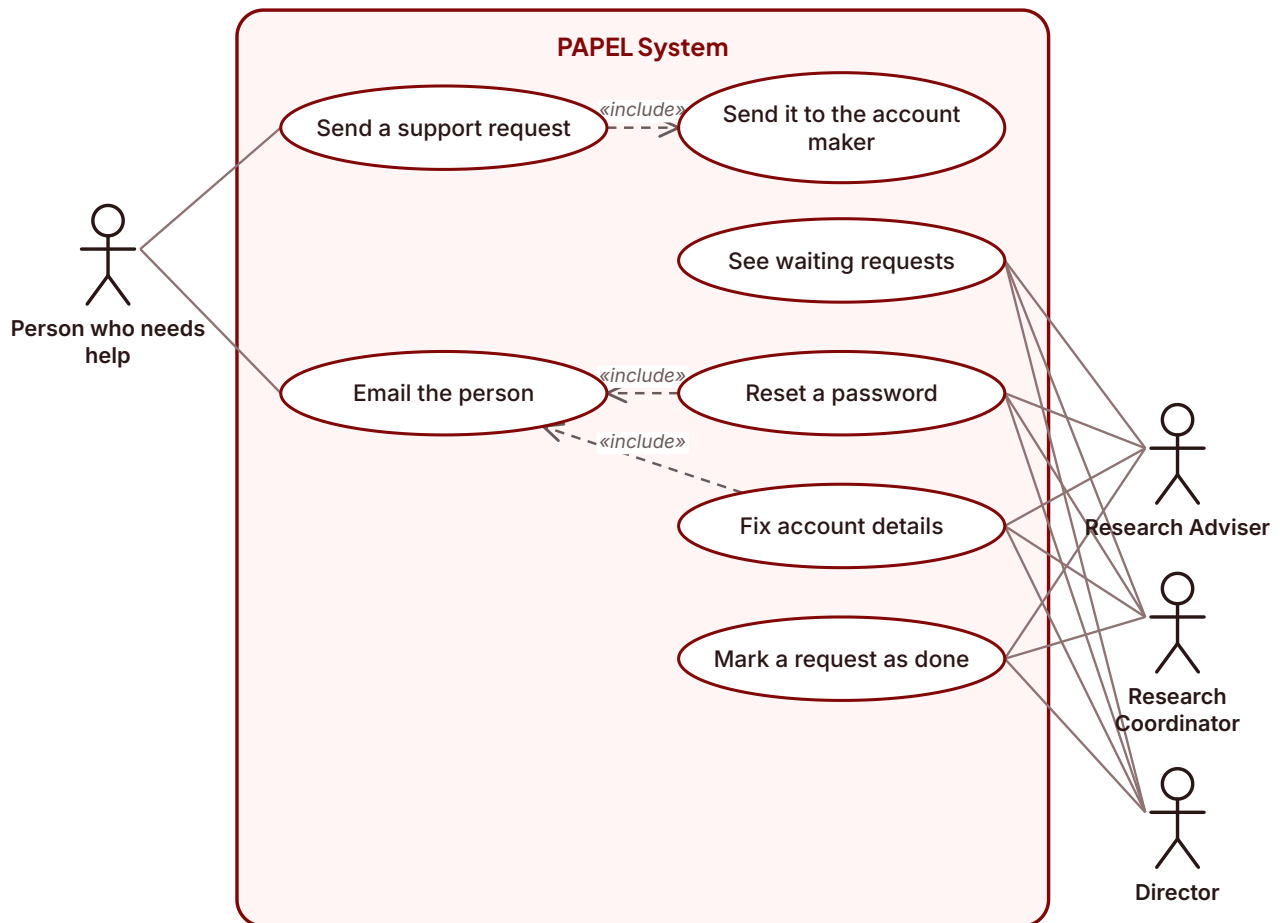
Handler —The person who deals with your request.

Reset —Set a new password in place of the old one.

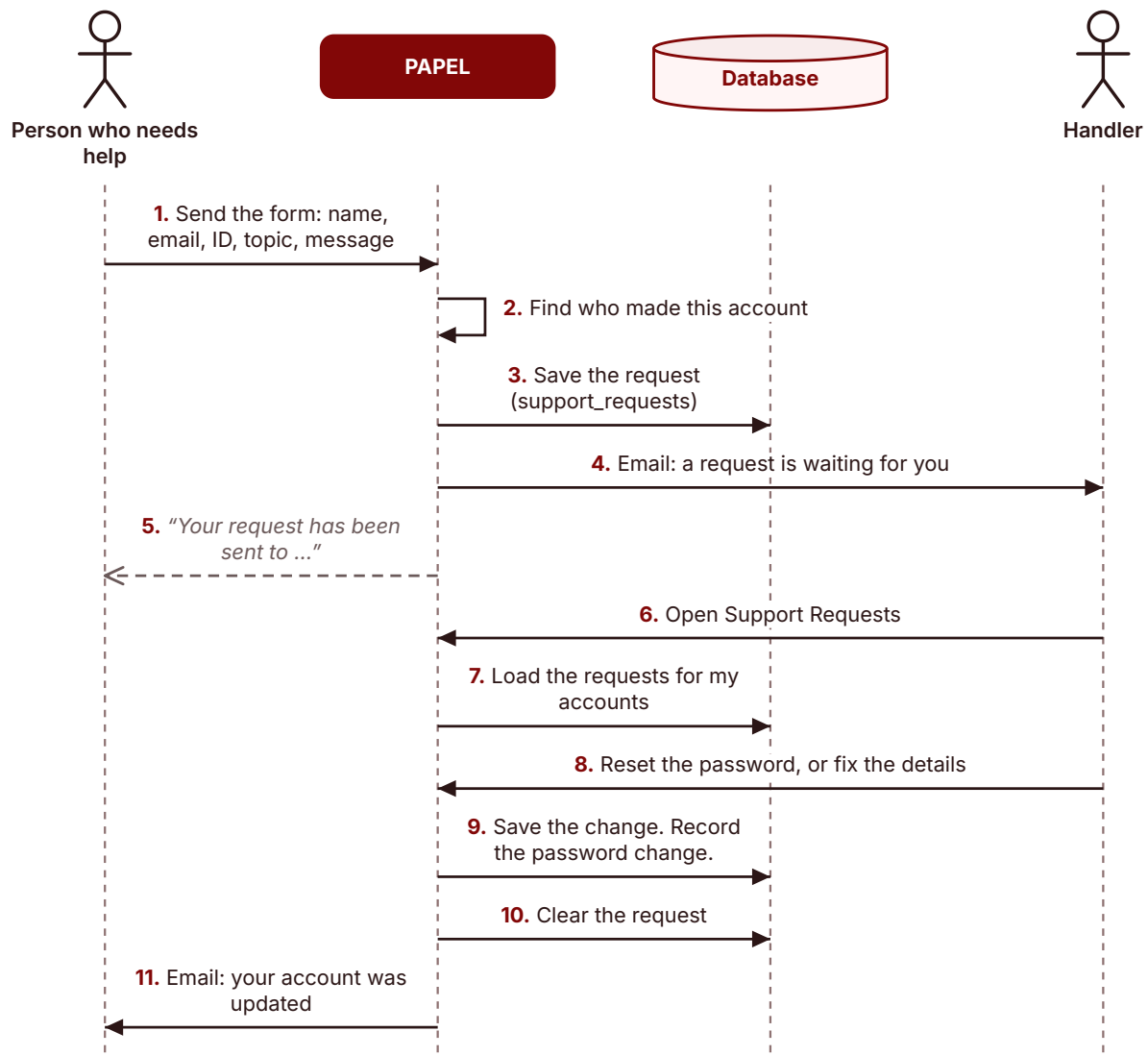
The diagrams for Workflow 14

Figure 14.1 USE CASE DIAGRAM

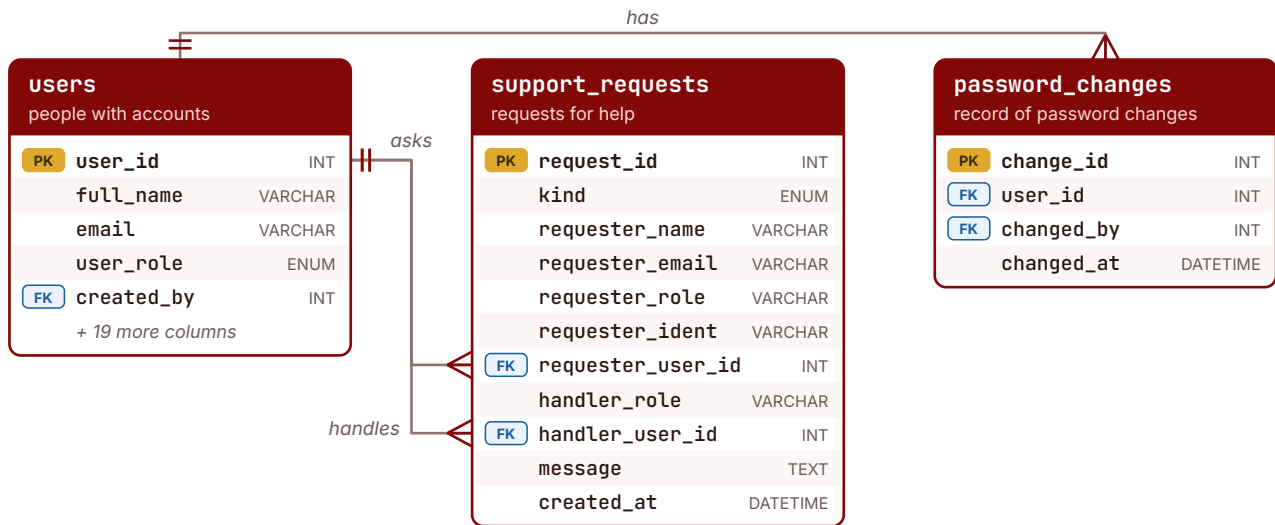
Who does what



What it shows: A request always goes to the person who made the account. When they fix it, PAPEL emails the person who asked.

Figure 14.2 SEQUENCE DIAGRAM**What happens, step by step**

What it shows: The request is cleared by the fix itself. The handler does not need to remember to close it.

Figure 14.3 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Where the information is saved**

A request is deleted when it is settled: by a new password, by saved details, or by Done. If the person could not sign in, `requester_user_id` may be empty; the name, email and ID they typed are kept instead.

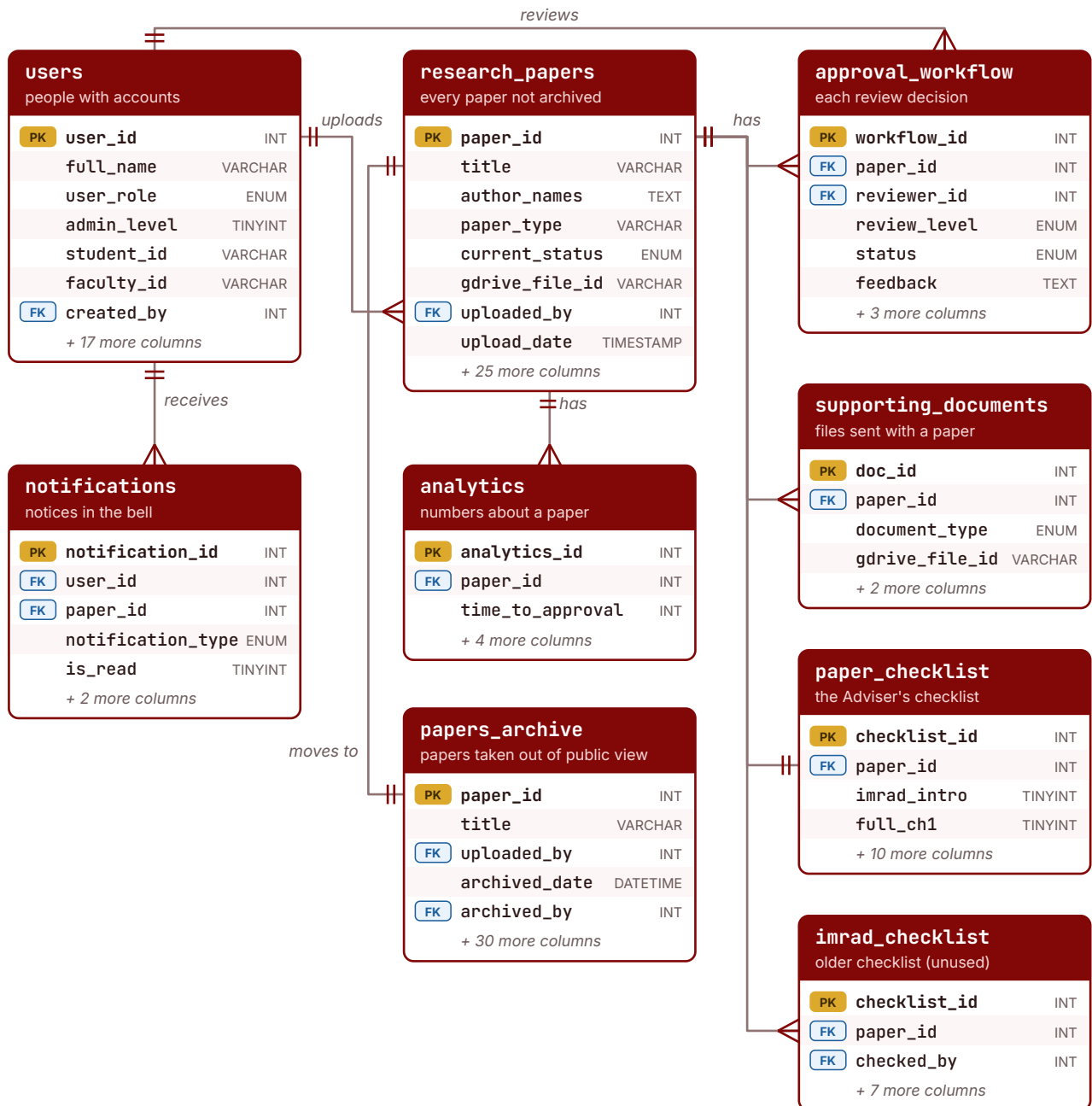
What it shows: A request points to two users: the person who asked and the person who handles it.

APPENDIX A

The Database Map

PAPEL saves everything in one database with 21 tables. These two pictures show the main tables and how they link.

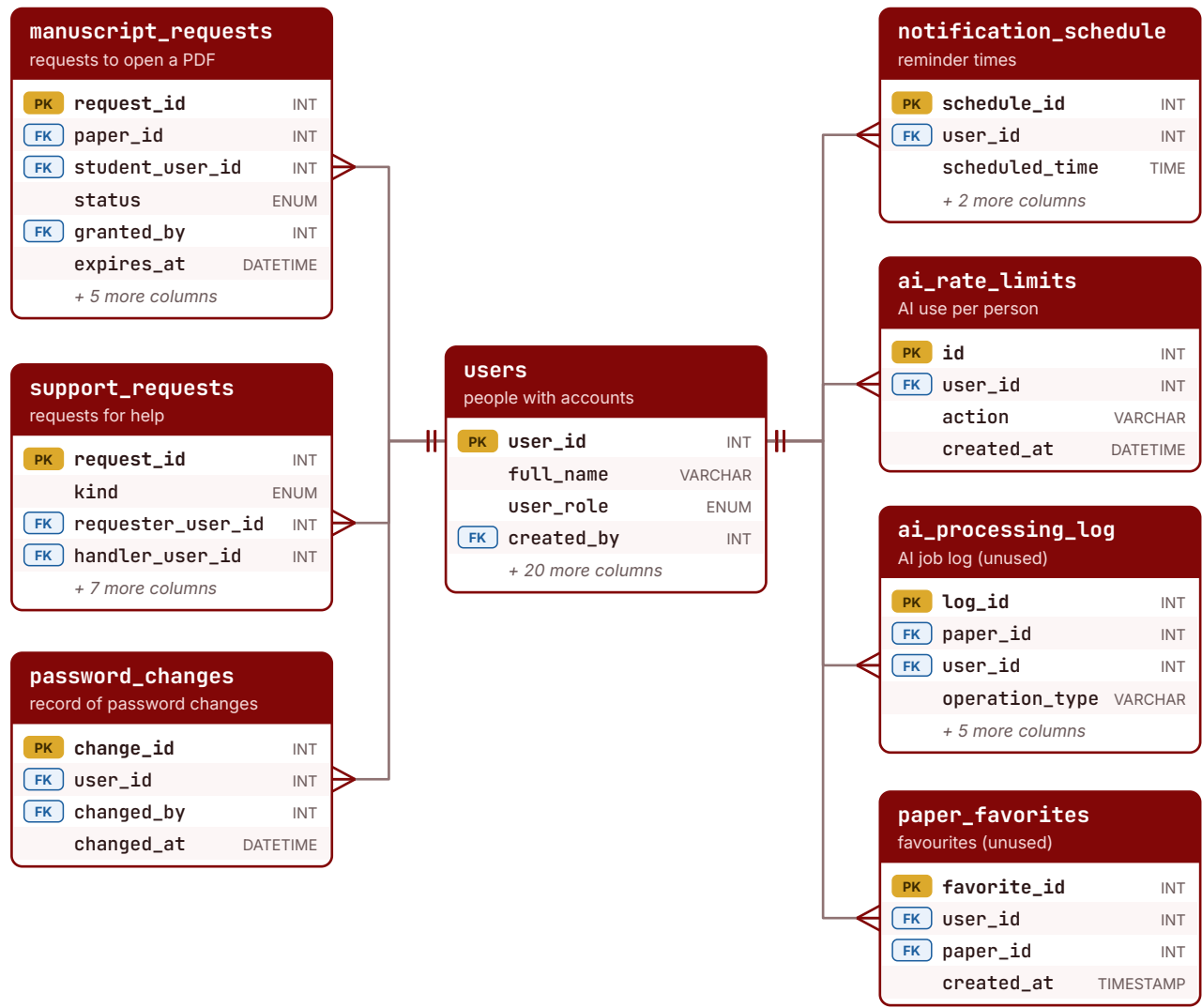
Most links are kept by the program, not forced by the database. For example, the database does not stop a paper from pointing to a user who was deleted. So when you delete rows by hand, delete the linked rows too.

Figure A.1 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)**Papers and reviews**

What it shows: The paper tables. Every paper belongs to the user who uploaded it. Its review decisions, documents, checklist and numbers point back to it by paper_id.

Figure A.2 ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)

Access, help and settings



The three tables below are not linked to other tables by ID. gdrive_settings and storage_usage are not drawn: nothing uses them.



What it shows: Every line here means: one user has many rows in that table. The tables in the bottom row stand alone.

All 21 tables

Table	What it holds	Columns
users	Everyone with an account: students and staff.	24

Table	What it holds	Columns
<code>research_papers</code>	Every paper that is not archived: drafts, papers under review and published papers.	33
<code>approval_workflow</code>	Each review decision: who decided, approve or return, and the feedback.	9
<code>paper_checklist</code>	The parts of the paper the Research Adviser ticked when approving.	14
<code>imrad_checklist</code>	An older section checklist. No page uses it now.	10
<code>supporting_documents</code>	Ethics clearance, consent form and the other files sent with a paper.	6
<code>analytics</code>	Numbers about a paper. Only <code>time_to_approval</code> (days from upload to approval) is written today.	7
<code>notifications</code>	The notices shown in the bell. Each one is also sent by email.	7
<code>notification_schedule</code>	The times when a person gets a reminder about waiting papers.	5
<code>papers_archive</code>	Papers moved out of the Public Repository. Kept for the record.	35
<code>guest_sessions</code>	Guest passes and the time each one ends.	6
<code>login_attempts</code>	Counts wrong sign-in tries, to stop people from guessing passwords.	5
<code>manuscript_requests</code>	Students' requests to open a full PDF, and the Librarian's answer.	11
<code>paper_favorites</code>	Meant for favourite papers. No page uses it yet.	4
<code>password_changes</code>	A record of every password change: whose, by whom and when.	4
<code>support_requests</code>	Forgotten-password and account-problem requests, waiting for a handler.	11
<code>system_settings</code>	System settings, such as the Google Drive connection and folder.	5
<code>gdrive_settings</code>	Older Google Drive settings. No page reads it now; <code>system_settings</code> is used instead.	5
<code>ai_processing_log</code>	Meant as a log of AI jobs. No page writes to it now.	9
<code>ai_rate_limits</code>	Limits how often one person can use the AI helpers.	4
<code>storage_usage</code>	Meant for storage checks. No page writes to it now.	7

APPENDIX B

Common Questions

Short answers to questions people often ask.

Where is my paper now?

Open your dashboard. The tab tells you. **Under Review** means a reviewer has it. The progress tracker on the card shows who: the Research Adviser or the Research Coordinator.

Why was my paper returned?

Open **Needs Revision**. The card shows the **Revision feedback**. It says what to change.

Why must I attach my PDF again after a return?

When a paper is returned, PAPEL deletes its files from Google Drive to save space. So the new version needs a new upload.

I saved my work, but my PDF is gone. Why?

You probably have only the automatic copy. It keeps your typing, but not the PDF. Use **Save as Draft** to keep the PDF too.

Can I change my paper after I submit it?

Only by cancelling it, and only at the allowed times (Workflow 5). Otherwise, wait for the review. If it is returned, you can change it then.

I cannot sign in. What can I do?

Check that you chose the right tab. Wait 15 minutes if you tried too many times. If your student account expired, ask your Research Adviser. If you forgot your password, use **Contact Support** (Workflow 14).

Who approves my paper?

Two people: first your Research Adviser, then the Research Coordinator. After the Coordinator approves it, it is published.

Does the Director or the Head of Academic Programs approve papers?

No. They read the published papers. The approval ends at the Research Coordinator.

Why can I not open the full PDF of a published paper?

The full PDF is for staff. Students can ask a Librarian for access for up to 24 hours (Workflow 11).

Is my draft public?

No. Only you can see a draft. Nobody reviews it until you submit it.

How long does a guest pass last?

From 1 to 24 hours. The Librarian chooses when making it.

Is an archived paper deleted?

No. It is kept in the archive record. It is only taken out of the Public Repository.

APPENDIX C

Words to Know

The words in this handbook, explained simply.

Abstract	A short summary at the start of a paper.
Actor	In a use case diagram: a person or an outside service that uses the system.
alt (frame)	In a sequence diagram: a box with two or more paths. Only one path happens. The words in [brackets] say when.
Approve	Say yes to a paper, so it moves to the next step.
Archive	A safe place for old records. They are kept, but not shown to the public.
Column	In a table: one kind of information, like "title" or "email".
Database	Where PAPEL saves its information, in tables.
Draft	A paper that is not finished and not sent.
ERD	Entity Relationship Diagram. A picture of the database tables and how they link.
«extend»	In a use case diagram: this step happens only sometimes.
Feedback	A reviewer's comments about what to change.
FK (foreign key)	An ID in one table that points to a row in another table.
Google Drive	A Google service that keeps files online. PAPEL keeps submitted PDFs there.
Guest pass	A username and password that work for a few hours.
«include»	In a use case diagram: this step always happens as part of the other one.
Lifeline	In a sequence diagram: the dashed line under each part. Time goes down it.
Manuscript	The full text of a paper, as a PDF file.
Metadata	Basic facts about a paper: title, authors, year, keywords.
Notice (notification)	A short message from PAPEL, shown in the bell and sent by email.

opt (frame)	In a sequence diagram: a box of steps that happen only sometimes.
PDF	A file type for documents. It looks the same on every computer.
PK (primary key)	The ID that makes each row in a table different from the others.
Publish	Make a paper public in the Public Repository.
Public Repository	The part of PAPEL where anyone can find approved papers.
Return	Send a paper back to the student to fix.
Row	In a table: one record, like one paper or one user.
Sequence diagram	A picture of the steps behind the screen, in time order, from top to bottom.
Status	Where a paper is in the process, like "draft" or "approved".
Submit	Send a paper for review.
Table	In a database: a list of rows with the same columns, like a spreadsheet.
Use case	In a use case diagram: one thing a person can do with the system.
Use case diagram	A picture of who uses a part of the system and what they can do there.

APPENDIX D

Notes for the System Team

For the people who run and change PAPEL. The rest of the handbook does not need this.

Which file does the work

Workflow	Main files
1 Signing In	<code>app/auth/login.php</code> , <code>config/core.php</code> (login throttle, account expiry)
2 Creating Accounts	<code>app/faculty/faculty_manage_students.php</code> , <code>app/admin/admin_manage_faculty.php</code> , <code>app/admin/super_admin_manage_admins.php</code> , <code>includes/password_generator.php</code>
3 Uploading a Paper	<code>app/student/student_upload_ai.php</code> (action <code>upload_paper</code>), <code>config/gdrive_config.php</code>
4 Saving a Draft	<code>app/student/student_upload_ai.php</code> (action <code>save_draft</code>), <code>app/student/student_draft_delete.php</code>
5 Cancelling	<code>app/student/student_cancel_submission.php</code> , <code>config/workflow.php</code> (<code>submission_cancel_state</code>)
6 Adviser Review	<code>app/faculty/faculty_review_dashboard.php</code> , <code>includes/review_console.php</code>
7 Coordinator Review	<code>app/admin/admin_review_dashboard.php</code> , <code>app/models/PaperService.php</code>
8 Returned Papers	<code>app/student/student_dashboard.php</code> (Needs Revision tab), <code>config/gdrive_config.php</code> (<code>purge_paper_drive_files</code>)
9 Public Repository	<code>archive/index.php</code> , <code>archive/view_paper.php</code> ; files are shown by <code>includes/pdf_dock.php</code> and <code>asests/js/papel-pdf-view.js</code> , from <code>app/paper_file.php</code>
10 Guest Passes	<code>app/librarian/librarian_manage_guests.php</code> , <code>app/auth/login.php</code> (Guest tab)
11 Manuscripts	<code>archive/view_paper.php</code> (request), <code>app/librarian/manuscript_requests.php</code>
12 Archiving	<code>app/admin/super_admin_review_dashboard.php</code> , <code>app/models/ArchiveService.php</code> , <code>notifications/cron/auto_archive_papers.php</code>
13 Notifications	<code>config/core.php</code> (<code>create_notification</code>), <code>notifications/notification_center.php</code> , <code>notifications/cron/send_notifications.php</code>
14 Support	<code>pages/contact_support.php</code> , <code>app/support_requests.php</code>

Tasks that must be scheduled

These scripts do nothing unless Windows Task Scheduler (or cron on Linux) runs them. Run them with the PHP command line, for example `php notifications/cron/auto_archive_papers.php` .

Script	How often	What it does
<code>notifications/cron/auto_archive_papers.php</code>	Every day	Archives approved papers more than 1,825 days old (Workflow 12).

Script	How often	What it does
<code>notifications/cron/send_notifications.php</code>	Every 15 minutes	Sends reminders at 10:00 and 15:30 to people with a reminder time (Workflow 13).
<code>scripts/gdrive_keeplive.php</code>	Every week	Keeps the Google Drive connection from expiring.

Where the files live

Files	Where
Submitted papers and their supporting documents	Google Drive, in the folder the Director chose. The server copy is deleted after the upload. Readers see them through <code>app/paper_file.php</code> , which passes the file on from Drive without keeping a copy. Keep the folder's link sharing at Viewer: at Editor, anyone holding a link could change or delete a paper.
Draft PDFs	On the server: <code>app/student/uploads/drafts/<user_id>/</code>
Pictures pasted into sections	On the server: <code>uploads/section_images/<user_id>/</code>
Older papers from before Drive-only storage	Some are still in <code>app/student/uploads/research/</code> . <code>scripts/migrations/run_drive_only_cleanup.php</code> removes the ones Drive already holds.

Back up the database **and** the two server folders above. Google Drive has no copy of drafts or pictures.

Old status values

The `current_status` column still allows values from the old four-step chain.

Status	What PAPEL does with it
<code>pending_admin_l1</code>	Treated like <code>pending_admin</code> : waiting for the Research Coordinator.
<code>pending_head_academic</code> , <code>pending_admin_l2</code> , <code>pending_super_admin</code>	From the old four-step chain. Shown as past the Coordinator. New papers never get them.
<code>declined</code> , <code>archived</code>	Allowed by the column, but not written today. A returned paper is <code>draft</code> with feedback; an archived paper moves to <code>papers_archive</code> .

Two accounts do the Head of Academic Programs job

A `head_academic` account, and an `admin` account with `admin_level = 2`. Both land on `app/faculty/head_review_dashboard.php`. Any role check must cover both.

Things found while writing this handbook

- The Research Coordinator's approval notice is saved with the type `progress` (`app/models/PaperService.php` , `approvePaper`). `progress` is not one of the values `notifications.notification_type` allows. On this XAMPP, where MariaDB is not in strict mode, the notice is saved with a blank type. On a server in strict mode (the MariaDB default), the insert fails silently and the student gets the email but no notice in the bell.
- The upload page says PDFs may be up to 50 MB, but this XAMPP's `php.ini` has `upload_max_filesize` and `post_max_size` set to 40M. A PDF between 40 and 50 MB fails. Set both to at least 60M on every server.
- The approve dialog on the Review Desk asks for a "Note for the student" and says it is passed on. The Adviser's note is saved in `approval_workflow.feedback` , but no page shows it: the student dashboard, `paper_details.php` and the review console read feedback only from `declined` rows. The Coordinator's note is not saved at all: `admin_review_dashboard.php` does not pass it to `PaperService::approvePaper` .
- `analytics.view_count` , `download_count` and `citation_count` are never written. Only `time_to_approval` is (by `PaperService::recordTimeToApproval`).
- Five tables are not used by any page: `imrad_checklist` , `paper_favorites` , `ai_processing_log` , `storage_usage` and `gdrive_settings` .

This handbook was built from the code on 23 September 2026 by `docs/handbook/build_handbook.py` . Run it again after a change to a workflow.